

ARNICA BUTLER

THE HOUSEGUEST

A NOVEL ABOUT SHARING
(AND) TEMPTATION



Thirteenth Line Publications



THE HOUSEGUEST

A Novel About Sharing (and) Temptation

By Arnica Butler

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PREFACE

When I began writing *The Houseguest*, I wanted to do something different from my typical story, which is to explore a hotwifing relationship that isn't just a one-off, maybe starting in the middle of a relationship. I often have this inclination, but the story somehow ends up falling through on me. If I trapped myself in a situation such as the one in the book, I thought, there's no way I could wriggle out of dealing with the ongoing relationship.

True enough, there wasn't. However, the story got really, really long, and it turned into two stories in my mind. I haven't published for a long time, and so I had the idea that there really was a way to deliver a discreet story in each of the two parts. This first part is more like my usual fare: the buildup and the teasing. I have a lot of fun writing that kind of thing, and I guess I keep going back to it no matter how hard I try to start in the middle of a relationship because it's my favorite part. There is no cliffhanger at the end of this book: you can enjoy what has happened as a complete, fun, escapist story that simply ends here because it ends here.

But, I've already written about half of the remaining story, which is what happens afterward, when this couple has a bull living in their house. It's a lot more delicate work, and it's outside of my own comfort zone. I'm excited about it but I can't say how long it will take me to finish. That's why I've decided to go ahead and publish this part now.

I know some people hate sequels and two-parters. I'm honestly not trying to vex my readers by doing things this way. I just wanted to get a story out, and I think what is here can genuinely be enjoyed within its own right. So, as always, please enjoy!

CHAPTER 1: REUNIONS

“I think I'm ready to go,” Natalie whispered to me as she leaned gently against the bar. She wobbled a little, but she made it look smooth.

Sort of.

“Oh yeah?” I smiled, reaching instinctively for her elbow to help prop her up. She smiled and leaned her whole arm on the bar as her ultra-high pumps gave way to her inebriation. She had to take a lurching step out of one of them, in order to catch herself before she went down like a felled tree.

“Oh, *yeah*,” she said, nodding.

She looked down to lift her foot and put it into her shoe, which was an extremely sexy black heel about an inch and a half higher than she usually wore. I thought the pumps were fantastic, because they reminded me of the Natalie who had actually turned my head and caused me to run into a newspaper vendor eleven years before. Natalie's legs – undoubtedly her best feature because they are long and flawlessly toned – were always nice. But they were show-stopping when she put on very high heels and flaunted them a little with a short skirt like the one she was wearing that night.

But unfortunately for Natalie, it had been a long time since she had done two things: wear heels that high, or have three glasses of red wine in quick succession.

It had also been a long time, I noted with pleasure, since Natalie had been as much *fun* as she was being right now. She moved her head so that her hand, still propped up on the bar, pushed her thick brown hair from her face. Natalie's hair was sort of unremarkable in color, but shiny like polished oak wood. I enjoyed the way she pushed it out of her face and gave it a shake. “If I have to listen,” she confided, and wobbled again in her shoes as she put her foot back into the one she had stepped out of, “to one more person tell me how they invented Post-Its, I am going to pepper-spray someone.” She looked down again, as if her shoes had a mind of their own and she needed to see what they were doing. “Jesus, these shoes.”

Natalie stepped out of the pumps and leaned toward me. “The only person I can stand here is Jake Matcher, and that's because...” she leaned

very close to me, silly and drunk, “He worked for Theranos and so he keeps his mouth closed.”

“Theranos...?” I say.

Natalie waved her hands impatiently at me. “Just make the call,” she said. Then she leaned on the bar facing the bartender, who, I noticed with some satisfaction, immediately attended to her with a charming smile. Natalie had one foot resting on her opposite calf now, and she was squirming a little in her bare feet. The dress she was wearing was shorter than her usual get-ups, and the material slid a little up her legs as she squirmed. It gave me (and everyone in the bar) an enhanced view of her legs, and a tantalizing hint of what was further up.

I noted as I leaned backward against the bar and took out my phone that the nice view had not gone unnoticed by Natalie's old classmates. Many were stealing glances, or outright staring over their conversation partners' heads, at Natalie's thoroughbred legs. And possibly her cute butt, which hadn't done much besides get slightly fuller and more attractive in the past ten years since she'd seen most of these people.

I texted my friend Ethan. He was an old buddy from my high school and early university years who was, coincidentally, living in the Chicago area now. We were visiting Chicago for a variety of reasons: this reunion of Natalie's university classmates who had all been in some kind of special, ultra-academic bachelor program; a friend of Nat's in Evanston who had a new baby; and Ethan, who we had thrown into the mix because... why not? It wasn't every day you ran into someone from Yorkdale.

South Carolina.

You haven't heard of it.

I looked back at the bar with alarm when the bartender set a drink down in front of Natalie.

“Don't worry,” he assured me. “Club soda.”

Then he winked at Natalie.

She straightened up and stabbed at the ice with her straw, making a funny noise. It was heard to read, sort of like, “Ohhhh.” But it could have meant anything. *Oh, that's a young man I'd like to take a bite out of.* Or, *oh, I can't believe I'm so wasted.*

I arched my eyebrow in interest.

The phone buzzed in my hand.

“Okay,” I said, reading the text. “Ethan says we can be there any time. I called a cab.” I laughed when I looked back up at Natalie. “*And* they have wine.”

I watched her tip her head back and down the club soda. “Perfect,” she purred.

Something stirred inside of me. Natalie slid her feet back into her shoes, and watching the black pumps enclose her skin was unreasonably erotic. I felt my cock coming to life.

“I’m going to make the rounds,” she said. “Get a drink. Then we’re outta here.”

The bartender was ready with my refill of whiskey. His eyes were on my wife as he poured, though. When he looked back at me and saw me staring at him, he just shrugged and smiled.

I left him a big tip.

Natalie managed to stay in her shoes and walk with the slinky grace she had once possessed when she wore high heels. I watched the men she embraced gawk at her; there was definitely a remnant of wild attraction among most of them. Next Natalie was doing fist-bumps, which meant she was a little overdone, so I slammed my whiskey. It was probably advisable to get her out of here.

“Come on, tiger,” I said, taking her elbow again. I felt her shake in her heels and she leaned into me. “We have to go,” I explained to the inquisitive faces around us. “So sorry. I.. have a bit of a reunion myself.”

There was a lot of high-pitched squealing from the ladies, and some awkward cheek-kissing by the guys (this was a class of ultra-dorky people, most of whom seemed to be deep in the autism spectrum), before we staggered out to the lobby.

Natalie leaned against me. It was late spring, a strange time for a reunion and bitterly cold to our Southern sensitivities. She wrapped her shawl tightly around herself, but decided it wasn’t warm enough. She wormed her way under my peacoat and pressed her body up against mine.

Since she was in a tight-fitting dress, I could feel every pleasant curve of her body against me: her medium-sized and delightfully firm breasts, her narrow waist, the flare of her hips. Her neck was close to my lips because of the extra height the heels gave her, and I stole a kiss beneath her earlobe. A flash of gooseflesh raced over her neck, and she shivered against me.

For a moment, our eyes met, and there was a little crinkle in the air that we hadn't felt for a long time. I was sure she could feel my erection against her leg, fitting nicely in the fold of her hip – bless those heels. I'm it was why she had a wry little smile when she looked at me.

“Yo. Lovebirds. You gettin' in? Or I gotta bounce?” Our cabbie, who had evidently pulled up some time ago to very little fanfare from us, was leaning over the front bench and yelling out the window in an almost cartoonish Chicago accent.

Natalie made a purring noise again. “Such pleasant people up here, I'd almost forgotten.”

And then her soft body evaporated from inside of my coat, and she dropped herself neatly into the cab, long legs last.

CHAPTER 2: ETHAN

“Holy shit,” I said under my breath.

Natalie, who was still being tons of fun, leaned over my lap and looked out the window on my side of the street. She moved her head from side to side, and then started laughing at herself. The weight of her warm body on my lap, and the feel of her soft breasts brushing on my cock through my pants, got me thinking some very dirty thoughts again.

“There's nothing out there,” she said, feigning indignation. “I thought there was something cool over here.”

She pushed herself up, kissed me on the cheek, and fell back onto her side of the car.

I forgot all about the neighborhood we were in – a community of old, brick mansions and vast manicured lawns. I regarded my wife, who pushed her hair out of her face again and then looked back at me.

Her cheeks were flushed with the damp chill in the air, and Natalie's imported-from-England porcelain skin stayed rosy for a long time once it flushed. Her blue eyes were smiling, and she looked a little mischievous, which is a quality I loved in Natalie and hadn't seen for quite some time. She had even asked the cabbie to stop at a shoe store, and had come out with a pair of cheap bright pink flats with olive daisies on them. “Go big or go home,” she had said with a shrug, tossing the tissue paper at me and slipping on the flats.

This was a nice change from Natalie Blanche-Ossington, soccer mom, mini-van driver, baker of muffins every Sunday, coupon huntress. Wearer of the strained suburban mom smile. Not that I minded that woman: she was a loving mother, she ran a tight ship filled with freshly-baked peanut-free muffins, and she was a great wife.

But *this* Natalie, Natalie Blanche, was admittedly a lot more *fun*.

A lot more like the woman I had married. Which I am not being some asshole and saying is the kind of woman who could be (or should be) raising kids and running a household. In fact, I hadn't even realized how much she'd changed until that evening. Her personality had just slowly eroded away, and all of the fun things she used to do just disappeared, little by little.

"I guess it's right up here," I said to the cabbie, who said nothing in return. This was a guy who had probably driven a cab his whole life. He shot daggers out of his eyes each time I had tried to be helpful by telling him what Google had to say about where we were going.

"59 Meadowfield Lane," he said, and the cab rolled toward the curb.

"You su-"

"This is it."

Whether it was or it wasn't, this was where we were getting out, his voice said.

I gave him a fifty on a \$42.00 fare because I didn't feel like asking the guy for change. "Thanks," I said, and he made no move to get change anyway. A slight nod of his head wrapped up the conversation.

We scooted out, curb-side.

"Wow," Natalie said. In her hot-pink shoes she was a lot more stable, but she did look a lot more comical. I stood next to her in front of the enormous brick steps (ten steps up to a platform of brick, then ten more up to the door of the white-columned, mammoth house). Well-placed lighting cast a glow on huge maples trees, speckled with the buds of early spring. I looked down at my phone again to check the address. Nat leaned over to check it with me.

"You didn't tell me this Ethan guy was loaded," she said, and her voice had a tinge of mischief in it.

Or so I decided to think.

"You thinking of trading up?" I said, and gave myself a pleasurable pang of jealousy at the thought.

She linked her arm through mine and gave her hair a toss. Then she utterly surprised me by saying: "Let's see about the rest of the package."

Indeed. Let's.

We climbed the steps and rang the doorbell.

Ethan answered the door.

I hadn't seen him for almost nine years; he missed our wedding for some good reason I couldn't even recall at the moment. I gave him a quick appraisal: he looked almost exactly the same. Ethan had always been a real lady-killer, though not because he was suave or devastatingly handsome. He had an athlete's body, and the kind of rough-edged look that usually see on rugby captains, or quarterbacks who play for teams that let their man get sacked a lot. His face was good-looking in a tough kind of way, and he had

a stare of focused intensity that had forced some permanent grooves into his forehead. He was kind of like a dark, American Gordon Ramsay. He was dressed in a nice shirt and an expensive pair of jeans, a sort of understated rich-casual look that was a definite upgrade from his university years. Seeing him after so long, I felt a flinch of fear that he was going to spring on me and give me a noogie.

“Erik,” he growled, but it was subdued, and he made no move to jump on me. “How the fuck are you, man?” He somehow got a hold of my hand – nothing had changed about his dominating, bone-crushing grip, and pulled me toward him in a clapping bear-hug. “So good to see you, buddy.”

There was a genuine, almost subdued tone to his voice, and it was strange. But he released me quickly and turned his attention to my wife. “You must be Natalie,” he said.

Ethan of the former years would have taken Natalie's hand, and brought it to his lips. Instead, he swung his arms open and pushed the door wide, indicating that we should come in. “Get out of the cold, darlin.” His eyes fell down to her shoes – taking, I noticed, a long, lingering walk over her legs. “Nice kicks.”

I turned to Natalie to see her reaction to Ethan, because I'd been anticipating it with a mixture of anxiety and perverse pleasure since we'd planned out trip. I felt sure I perceived a little ripple go through her as Ethan's steely blue eyes met hers, but the sobering-up Natalie did not melt into a pile of goo or bat her eyelashes.

She did, however, hold up her high-heeled pumps as an answer, before stepping into the house.

It was the sort of care-nothing attitude that the old Natalie might have had. Natalie-soccer-mom might have been mortified, and rushed to explain her outrageous shoe choice, but tonight's drunk Natalie set her pumps down neatly on the ground and didn't say “boo.”

Ethan was right there to slide her shawl from her shoulders. “Let me get this for you,” he said.

I got a nice stab of heat straight through my gut as Ethan's hands – veined and wiry with strength – slid over Natalie's shoulders. His fingers very deliberately lingered, just a tad too intimately, on her collar bone, brushing her skin as he swept the shawl off. Then he trailed his hands along her arm – not really obviously, of course, but I knew Ethan well, and I knew

what he was doing – as he slipped it down to her wrists. This last gesture was unnecessary, it being a wrap-around shawl and all.

And I had money on it that he grazed the bump of her ass, maybe just at her tailbone, as he pulled the shawl together behind her. After just a moment too long, he turned to hang it up in the closet behind him.

Natalie looked at me and her eyes went wide. But she was still in a playful mood, apparently, because there wasn't any anger behind it, just... amazement.

“You, hang your own coat up,” Ethan said to me. “I'm goin' escort this lovely lady inside and get her somethin' to warm her up.”

Ethan's smooth, Southern charm was on extra-high, I noted with a mix of chagrin and slightly perverse delight.

Ethan linked his arm through Natalie's, who turned like a doll in a jewelry box under the guidance of Ethan's stare, as all women did, and followed him.

I was left to handle my own coat.

For the next hour or so, we chatted with the clusters of people at their cocktail party. It was excruciating: the usual volley of what-do-you-do's and oh-how-interesting's, and one upmanship (“Oh you think the *Beijing* airport is bad, have you been to Taipei?”) I was trying to get Natalie's attention, but she was deeply, deeply immersed in conversation with none other than:

Ethan.

It gnawed at me in a special kind of way that the two of them were hitting it off so well. For one thing, Ethan was everything I would have expected Natalie to hate. He was a jock's jock, he was a dominating, anti-feminist, charmy-charms guy, and he was pathologically incapable of not flirting with every woman he came into contact with.

But maybe that was the old Ethan. I had no idea. I hadn't had a chance to talk to him at all that evening, because his wife, Moira, had pulled me into a conversation with a small group of doctors.

I suppose because I'm a lawyer, everyone figured I'd fit in there.

My attention, though, was really on Ethan and Natalie. The way Natalie's voice kept rising and falling in genuine bursts of laughter. She had a kind of hammy, over-the-top laugh that she got going if she found something really funny, but Natalie was also a tough sell with humor. She only went for clever plays on words, or acerbic, smart jokes, and Ethan

hardly seemed like the type to deliver. Yet he had her laughing, had her touching her throat. At one point I looked over to see Ethan leaning in close to her, showing her something on his wrist. He was close enough that Natalie could breathe in his musky man-smell, and maybe he even grazed her cheek with the scratchy stubble that seemed to have grown on his face while we were standing there. Natalie was smiling, and it felt like hot coals were turning over inside of me, thinking about Ethan standing so close to her lips. He was probably thinking about tasting them.

“Don't you think?” Moira was looking at me expectantly when I turned back to the conversation, and my mind was miles away, conjuring up dirty images of her husband and my wife.

“It's an interesting thought,” I said diplomatically, vaguely remembering that the conversation had touched on transportation in Chicago. “But I'm from South Carolina. This stuff is way over my head.”

Blank stares.

“Why, we don't even have snow there!” I half-yelled, in my Foghorn-Leghorn accent.

The joke, which I kept in my pocket for just such occasions, landed as it always did and charmed the crowd. Their loud laughter allowed the perfect foil for excusing myself to go to the bathroom.

When I came out, almost everyone was gone or leaving, and Ethan finally broke away from Natalie. “Erik, buddy, you can't go yet. I didn't even get to talk to you.” He crossed the room and pulled me along, through the kitchen and out to a semi-enclosed porch, where a heat lamp was blazing away with no one underneath it. It felt like South Carolina on the porch.

He fished two cigars out of his pocket.

A fucking cigar.

He offered me one and shook my head.

“Wow,” Ethan said, cutting the cigar. I'm no aficionado but it seemed like a good one. “Wow, Natalie, wow, man.” He placed the cigar in his mouth and lit it. “She's really something.”

“She is tonight,” I said agreeably.

Ethan raised his eyebrows. I brought my beer to my lips, expecting an onslaught of inappropriate things to come gushing out of Ethan's mouth. So I was stunned enough to almost spit my beer out when he said, in a soft voice: “You guys have a really... nice dynamic. You seem really close.”

He sounded almost... remorseful.

And cheesy.

Jesus, fuck, what was going on?

"Yeah," I said lamely, not knowing what else to do. As far as I knew, Natalie and I hadn't said two words to each other since we came through the front door.

I was instantly on guard. It was just like Ethan to lead you up the path of some genuine-seeming conversation about feelings, and then be a huge dick. A peal of laughter came from the kitchen, and it wasn't Natalie's.

This made Ethan's face fall a little.

Even though Ethan had punked me so many times with a conversation just like this one, I felt the usual need to cheer him up. Man, some things don't change no matter how many years go by.

"Moirra is great," I said quickly. "And, shit, Ethan, this house... you've really done well for yourself."

"Thanks, man," he said, but it was almost as though he hadn't heard me. He took another puff of his cigar, staring into the semi-darkness of the kitchen through the glass doorway.

He didn't seem too happy with the compliment, which was extremely un-Ethan-like. The Ethan I had known was a narcissist who loved hearing about himself or the things he possessed.

An awkward silence descended.

"Uh... so, what are you doing these days?" I tried. "Looks like I need to get in on it."

No answer for a beat.

"Hedge funds," he said. "I told you that, didn't I?"

He had, but it was really unlike Ethan to remember anything about a conversation. He sounded almost sad.

"I don't really want to talk about work, man. It's stressful," he said, before I could try to smooth over the weirdness that again loomed over the conversation. He brightened and asked: "What are you guys up to? How's Yorkdale? You got kids, right? Dogs? See any people from school?"

"Uh, yeah," I stuttered. "Good. Things are good. Two kids. One dog."

I left the "people from school" bit alone. I preferred to never see, or talk about, any of those yokels again. I could barely believe I was back there, living in the same town I had grown up in.

"What's Natalie do?"

“Uh... she's home right now, she's an artist, so she works on that, but it's sort of... I dunno, hobby-work. The kids keep her busy.”

This conversation was weird.

“What kind of art?”

I was caught off-guard. Ethan seemed genuinely interested in the answer.

“It's... sort of...”

“Paintings? Sculptures? What?” Ethan was getting his fast-paced talking on. He was a really impatient, demanding person, so hedge-fund management didn't seem that out there as a career for him. I just hadn't known he was any good with numbers.

“Paintings,” I said.

“Of what?”

How to describe? “You know, I... you'd have to have Natalie explain it to you, really, I'm not very... good at it.”

I wasn't. Natalie's paintings had moved into strange farm scenes with brightly colored horses and donkeys and birds on old bicycles, and they were pleasing to the eye but beyond that I didn't have the vocabulary to talk about them. No matter how much I listened in on art conversations, or wine conversations, I just couldn't get it up to dish out all those cheesedick adjectives about paintings or wine.

Ethan shocked me *even further* by saying: “You gotta pay more attention to your wife than that, man.”

Before there was any time for me to stand there looking stupid, or stunned, or to come up with some kind of answer, Natalie came into the kitchen for more wine. As she popped the cork, the strap of her dress slid off her shoulder and she grinned at us both. “Are you guys bonding out there or are you coming in sometime? We're having the *best* conversation about Moira's work, you have to hear some of this stuff.”

We went back into the living room. I sat next to Natalie, and I was pleased that whatever high she was on seemed to be continuing but steady: she was happily drunk and flirtatious, but not so far gone that I would lose out on any chance of sex to her vomiting in the hotel bathroom. She scooted closer to me and put her hand on my leg. It had been a long, long time since we had been out, together, in nice clothing, having uninterrupted

conversations that could keep going past ten. Even though I was exhausted, it was thrilling.

I noticed that Ethan sat in a chair, far away from Moira, who was curled up on the sofa opposite us and telling us about crazy patients who had gone through the ER. She was a great storyteller, and we were all laughing within five minutes.

Whenever I looked over at Ethan, though, his eyes were either distant, or his gaze fell somewhere on my wife. I looked over at Natalie's legs. She, too, had curled up on the couch, with her legs folded up to the side of her. Her dress had bunched up a little, and so I couldn't see but could imagine the view that Ethan had of slender thighs, one on top of the other, all the way up to the dark shadow between her legs. Without leaning over her, there was no way to tell if the dress had gone right up to her ass; it was entirely plausible to believe that Ethan had a view of her panties. And by the way he was staring, it seemed he might.

My reaction to it, however, was a wild mixture of feelings. Every time I looked over and saw his gaze drifting over Natalie's body, I felt a pang of jealousy, sure. But it ached in a thrilling way. There was also the usual feeling I had around Ethan, the one I hated but couldn't really shake or stand up to, the feeling that Ethan would just do whatever he wanted and I didn't really dare to tell him to stop.

I also enjoyed that my wife was so beautiful, her legs were on display so perfectly (because there really wasn't a sexier way for her to be sitting, from Ethan's point of view) that she was catching Ethan's attention. Finally, I had the hot chick, the cool chick (and Natalie was on fire tonight on both counts) and Ethan, who always won at everything, was the one feeling envious.

I couldn't really enjoy that feeling so much, though, because of the strange aura of pathos that was radiating from him. Especially when he laughed at Moira's jokes, kind of like he was doing it as part of an act. His eyes looked vacant when he wasn't groping Natalie visually.

He looked, on the whole, sort of sad.

And that was an emotion I had never, ever seen from Ethan Cooke.

The evening went on and the guests trickled away, and we decided at some point to get up and leave. I was pretty lit, and Natalie was getting tired. Ethan seemed to cling to us, asking us to stay for another drink, bordering on pathetic without ever quite getting there. But we resisted, and

soon we were on our way back to the hotel.

Natalie was looking out the opposite window when I finally got away from Ethan and dropped into the seat of the cab. The door closed and we drove away for a few minutes in silence. The cabbie wasn't a talker; he had a foreign-language radio station on and seemed to be about a hundred years old. I said a silent prayer he didn't drive us through the side of a house he had mistaken for a thoroughfare.

Natalie's hand slid over to mine and she took it. It was a tender, unfunny gesture. I looked over at her.

"I'm really glad we have each other," she said.

She was being totally serious now. It was a drastic shift from inside the house, so I cocked my head slightly. "What makes you say that, sweetie?" But I closed my fingers over her hand.

Even I like a little cheese every now and then.

"Just... oh, I don't know. Seeing those two. Really makes you realize what you have."

I furrowed my brow. "What, Moira and Ethan?"

She nodded.

Then she saw that I was confused, and I think I even caught a mild eyeroll from her. "They have all this money, and they both have these great careers, but they're so... unhappy. It's like they don't even know each other."

"Really?" I said. I was sort of taking pleasure in this, I'll admit. But I was also a little in the dark. I hadn't necessarily picked up on anything all that weird between those two.

"You couldn't tell?" Natalie said.

There was a faint hint of danger in her tone. It was the kind of danger that lurked in questions like, "What do you think of this dress?"

It was time for diplomatic and non-committal answers, but I was pretty drunk so I didn't have much faith in myself.

"I, uh... well, now that you mention it..."

"Right?" Natalie said, to my relief. "There's like a *wall* between them."

I was sort of thankful she looked out the window again thoughtfully.

Mainly, I was interested in saying the right thing to steer this ship back in the direction of fun, friendly sex, which had been on my mind since she'd put the dress on hours and hours ago. But Natalie was teetering on the

edge of some kind of over-emotional breakdown, which could happen to her if she had too much to drink.

“Let's never get like that,” she said wistfully.

Oh God. Tippiiiiiiing....

Think, Erik, think.

“And what about *Ethan*?” Natalie burst out, turning to me and quite unexpectedly back to her mischievous personality. “Did you *see* the way he took that shawl off of me?”

I had.

I had no idea where this was headed.

“You told me he was a bit of a player but that guy...” she shook her head.

But she was smiling.

“Oh, come on,” I said. “You didn't mind it that much, did you? A bit of good, old-fashioned Southern charm?”

Natalie laughed and tipped her head back, bringing her fingers to her throat and sending my cock into a spasm again. Her laugh was low and sexy. “Yeah, his accent is just *too much*. Why don't *you* sound like that?”

“But you didn't really *mind*, did you?” I ventured.

Natalie opened her mouth to say something, and then she looked up at the cabby in the mirror. She looked from me to him, and smiled.

Whatever she wanted to say was inappropriate for the Pakistani cab driver.

I felt a flush of excitement.

And then I scooted over a little.

Our hotel was on the outskirts of Chicago, because it was cheaper, closer to Evanston, and Natalie's friend lived out that way. We had quite the drive to go, maybe twenty minutes at least.

I put my hand on Natalie's knee. I looked out my own window, as though I was up to nothing at all for the benefit of the cabby, and then I slid my hand up, along her thigh.

I could feel Natalie's body stiffen up with excitement. In the corner of my eye I saw that her lips parted slightly and she let out a little puff of air. I used my pinkie finger to stroke her inner thigh, and I was sure I could feel the pleasure raise bumps on her skin. I moved up, and as my hand went closer to the center of her thighs, the air against my hand was warmer.

When I touched the fabric of her panties with my pinkie, I could feel that it was damp.

And Natalie hadn't moved. Not to cover up what I was doing, not to push me away.

I used my thumb and pinkie to push her legs open a little more, and she simply let me. I stole a sideways, downward glance at the short skirt that was creeping up to mid-thigh, a little higher, as her lean legs parted.

I slid my pinkie finger beneath the fabric of her underwear. Now her wetness was obvious, and my finger was hot and slick as I brushed up and down the downy hair and into her soaked folds.

The angle was awkward, and I was gripped by a dizzying desire to throw myself onto her face-forward and rip her dress up and her panties off, but I held my gaze out the window and my body steady as my fingers dipped into her wet cunt.

She was so wet, I thought with pleasure.

And then I treated myself to the thought that maybe she was so excited because of Ethan's Southern drawl. That maybe what was making her stiffen and shudder next to me was not just my fingers brushing up against her swollen clit, but the thought of Ethan's hands sliding down her arms.

Her eyes dropped to half-closed, and I luxuriated in the pleasurable thought that she might be thinking about Ethan, imagining that if such a feather-touch could come from such wiry and strong hands, what could he do elsewhere?

As I thought about my wife thinking about another man, I used my pinkie finger to stroke the nub of her clit, which was hard and protruding through the layers of her soaked flesh. I dipped my ring and middle finger into her as I did this, and pressed upward to pinch her clit from the inside out. This drove her wild, and I could feel her excitement coiling up inside her body, which she was trying to keep immobile to hide what we were doing from the cabbie. Her lips fell open a little more, and her chest fluttered with her ragged breath. My thigh was against hers now, and I could feel the tension building in her legs.

My own cock was throbbing, and I could feel the sticky stain of precum oozing out of the crown. I wanted to fuck my load into my wife like I hadn't in a long time. But for now I had to settle for making her burst quietly in the seat next to me.

If the angle of my hand had been less twisted, she would have come in an instant. Instead, I had the fun of torturing her a little, making her wait, as I slowly stroked her clit. She lifted her hips a little as she neared her climax, to grind herself against my touch. I pulled away, and gave her a look to get her to settle down. I liked the control I had over her in that moment, and the way she had no choice but to sit back down and let me slide my finger over her at my own pace. The way she had to hide her excitement outwardly.

Finally, I felt her whole body turn to steel, and her eyes squeezed shut. A flush of crimson stained her cheeks, and she bit her lip. Her pussy seemed to explode into wet, sticky cum, and her legs quivered against my hand.

I kept going, because her orgasm was driving me wild. But she squeezed her legs together to crush my hand, and looked over at me fiercely. Her hair was a little damp near the temple. Her eyes were glassy with the look of just-earned pleasure, and she smiled a little. She shook her head slightly. "Not now," she mouthed.

I pulled my hand from between her legs. I waited a moment before I brought it to my nose, and inhaled her wildly excited scent. A mistake, because it only served to make my cock ache painfully, and we were still about ten minutes from our destination.

I looked over at Natalie.

"I'm not finished with you yet," I mouthed.

It wasn't the first time we had played this game.

I had more or less confessed my secret desires to Natalie, on many occasions, but Natalie seemed to take the whole thing as a joke. Or perhaps that's not the best way to put it: she didn't think it was funny or even that perverse, she just assumed it was for play-acting only. Like dressing up in a costume. So she had been willing, on a few occasions, to say that she was thinking about some other man while we had sex.

Much less so nowadays. In fact, I couldn't even remember the last time we had indulged in any kind of fantasy, or any kind of sex that wasn't just missionary-style sex. An item on checklist of things that needed doing twice a week, sort of like laundry.

But that night, we walked into the hotel like two new lovers. We were both excited, and I could feel it between us. The feeling itself was intoxicating, and so it fueled even further excitement. By the time we

opened the door to the room I could barely think about or feel anything but the ache in my cock and how much I wanted to sate it with Natalie's drenched cunt.

I pushed her against the wall and placed my hand on her chin, drinking up her mouth in mine. I shook off my coat to the floor as I did this. A little awkwardly, my hands got caught in the sleeves and I had to crush against her to get it off. But it was just more excuse to be melted into her body, and she didn't seem to mind.

"You seem really excited," I said suggestively, sliding my hand up to her panties and pulling them aside to get my fingers into her soaked folds again. My mouth was close to her lips, and I flung a prayer somewhere that she was going to play along. "Care to tell me why that is?"

Natalie was not a dumb chick, which had its advantages (at a time like this) and its disadvantages (at other times). Her mouth turned up suggestively and I knew she was going to go along with it tonight.

"You mean like Ethan?"

Even a sentence like that made me wild. I stroked her clit with my finger now, and I smiled back before I bit her lower lip lightly. "Like Ethan, huh?" I said. "You like thinking about Ethan?"

I saw a little flash of hesitant embarrassment color her cheeks, and her eyes dropped. But then her smile returned. "He has pretty nice hands," she murmured.

"Oh yeah?" I said, probing deeper into her wet flesh and making her gasp lightly. "And what makes you say that?"

Her eyes flickered up and met mine. Another shy smile, and then she dove in: "Well, you know what they say, the bigger the hands..."

There was, in Ethan's case (and I could attest to this, as could everyone in Yorkdale, because Ethan had no problem getting naked at pretty much any venue if he had the right motivation) a certain amount of truth to the hand-cock comparison. His cock, in fact, was a great deal like his hands: veined, good-sized, and thick.

Natalie pushed against my chest lightly, and I felt a pang of worry that maybe things had gone a bit too far for her. But her hands were hot through my shirt and they slid down my chest and began to work into my pants. She pulled my shirt out and they were back against my skin, moving over my chest. When her fingertips moved over my nipples they hardened

and she pinched me softly. Her hands moved back down, into my pants, under my boxers.

“Hmm,” she murmured, when her fingers brushed over my swollen cock, which by now was pressed tight up against my underwear and painfully into the zipper of my jeans. Her eyes met mine again, and my dick flexed with the sensual look she gave me. “You really like the idea of Ethan's big hands all over my body, don't you?”

Her hot fingers disappeared for a moment, and then I felt her unbuttoning my jeans, sliding the zipper down, pulling at my boxers. Just enough to free my cock, which sprang loose, sticky with precum and hard as it had been in my adult life. It rubbed against the silky material of her dress, and I reached down to pull the dress up just as she slithered away from me.

Down.

She slid down to her knees, gently pushing me back a step. The crown of my cock slid over her breasts and along her cheek as she came to rest on her knees. She brought her left hand up to grasp my cock, and gave it a squeeze. Her tongue flicked out to taste the precum dripping from the end of my dick. “You like it a lot,” she said.

My hands, all the while, had been suspended in the air sort of stupidly, because I was so taken aback by what she was doing. I dropped them to her hair, and I pushed it back from her face as she opened her mouth and used her hand to guide my cock inside of her wet mouth.

Her lips closed around the head of my cock, and I felt her tongue darting around on the contours of my glans. Dipping into the hole, sliding over the ridge of the crown, all the while just the aching head of my cock was enveloped in the heat of her mouth.

I sank my fingers into her hair, and then I grasped it and pulled her head forward as I watched her lips slide down my cock. At the middle of my shaft, I felt a slight resistance to going further, but when I pressed her gently she went ahead and took my whole dick inside of her mouth.

I stared at my shaft disappearing into Natalie's mouth until her lips reached the curls of pubic hair at the base.

I looked up at the ceiling, trying to block my mind from imagining that this was Ethan's cock, and that she had filled her whole mouth with his big, thick dick. I looked back down as she began to bob up and down the length of my cock, and her eyes lifted to meet mine.

I pictured the scene as though I were standing to the side, and the cock in her mouth was not mine, but another man's. That she was greedily slurping up Ethan's cock the way she was doing to me right now...

"Nat-" I breathed, and I touched the back of her head. I could feel the cum boiling up and I was about to burst in her mouth.

She released me just in time, and her left hand returned to my shaft. She pumped the cum from dick and let the ropes of creamy liquid streak her chest and her throat while she stared at the cum spurting from my cock.

"Fuck," I groaned, as my orgasm seized me.

Natalie fell back against the wall behind her, and looked up at me with a smile. Her hair was mussed, and she was sticky with cum all over her chest and even her cheek. I would never admit this to her, but the sight of her looking so defiled was incredibly thrilling – especially, *especially* if I let myself indulge in the idea that the white cum sinking into her skin was not mine, that the hands that had ruffled her hair were someone else's.

I put a hand against the wall to prop myself up, leaning over her.

"I hope you're not done yet," she said.

My head was still fuzzy, a light buzz making me half-deaf. I let my other hand fall to my cock, and it twitched when I touched it but I confirmed what I had thought was true: I wasn't done at all. "Get on the bed," I told her. I pushed myself away from the wall to let her get up.

She rose to her feet, sliding herself up against the wall, her eyes on mine. She was shorter now – she must have kicked off her shoes.

I put my thumb out and touched her lips. A shudder went through me as I imagined what it would be like to find a slippery drop of cum on her lower lip, knowing it wasn't mine. I put my hand behind her head and kissed her forcefully, moving at the same time toward the bed. I turned her around, and pushed her onto the bed on her hands and knees, face first.

Her dress had crawled up body by now, but I still had the pleasure of pushing it up and over the round hump of her ass. Her panties were a beautiful wreck like her hair and her face, damp and twisted from the several times I'd probed into her. I yanked at them and pulled them down to her knees.

I savored the sight for a moment, letting her squirm. She dropped her chest to the bed, so that her ass was turned up to me, her legs bound together at the knee by her dank panties, and her trimmed bush and dripping

cunt bursting from between her asscheeks. She was swollen with excitement, and the scent of her cunt was strong.

I knelt on the bed and pried her pussy lips apart with my fingers to expose the rosy-pink folds of her inner labia and the nest little button of her clit, which was engorged by now.

Then I bent over and pushed her forward so that I could explore her with my mouth.

My tongue slipped over her flesh like it was made of silk, because her own cum and her juices were still gushing around in her folds. She tasted sweeter than usual, though it had been forever since she had let me explore her cunt with my mouth. I sucked her clit up between my lips and pressed them together. Her body reacted violently with a shake. I did it again, and she squirmed.

I moved backward onto the floor and pulled her by the feet toward me. I liked her knees together like that, so I pushed her legs to the side and used my hands to hold her butt more or less facing me still. Then I pried her open with fingers and dove in. I pushed down with my tongue to get pressure on her clit, rhythmically kneading her knob, and I used my right hand to plunge into her hole and literally spread her wide open.

By then my cock was ready to go again, and even though it might have been fun to make her come all over my face, I wanted to sink my dick into her. I really wanted to fuck her, as dirtily as I could. I stood up, and Natalie sighed with disappointment because she had been tremblingly close to coming again.

I slid two fingers into her cunt, and cupped her ass with my wrist turned away. "Scoot up," I said, pushing her forward. She sort of crawled toward the head of the bed, my hand pushing her along. The submissive pose made my cock bounce wildly. I climbed onto my knees behind her, my hand still in her cunt.

I withdrew my hand, and as I did I drew my fingers up and over her asshole. An idea to try and go there, work my finger inside of her tight hole, crossed my mind. But one thing at a time, and better not press my luck, I thought.

I guided my cock to her hole, and I pushed it around in the folds of her pussy. Her hard clit darted around beneath the pressure of my crown, slipping away and making Natalie shake with each rub.

I gave myself a moment to think about how Ethan might fuck my wife. He was a filthy guy, with filthy ideas. Ethan wouldn't hesitate to dip his thumb deep into her ass and hold her in the palm of his hand while he slammed his cock in and out of her soaked cunt.

I wanted desperately to say that. Ask my wife how she thought Ethan would fuck her, and hear her tell me that he would fuck her pussy raw. My cock pulsed in my hand as I imagined in excruciatingly pleasurable detail what Natalie's mouth would look like saying the words, "fuck my pussy raw."

On that note, I wasn't going to make it much longer. I thrust myself into her, and slid my thumb up and over her asshole as I did, tantalizing myself one final time with the thought of dipping my finger into her hot flesh.

Natalie gripped the duvet cover as I slammed my cock inside of her. I looked down to watch my dick moving in and out of her pussy. It was so slick with her juices that it shone in the weak light of the hallway lamp – the only one we had turned on. I felt her pussy quivering around me, tightening up as she rode the wave of her own orgasm. I was worried I wasn't going to last until she came, but she came almost immediately after I had that thought. She pushed herself up on her hands and slammed her ass back into the hollow of my thighs, and the juices of her cunt splurged down and over my balls in a hot wave. I grasped her hips and pulled her onto me, sitting back as I did, and then pushed her up and down on my cock as I exploded inside of her spasming cunt.

She leaned back against me, her head tipped back. I reached around her and stroked her breasts through her crumpled dress, no longer part of anything sexual, just a feeling I enjoyed in my hands. Her throat rumbled and for a second I was unsure what kind of sound she was making. A croaking, drunken laugh escaped her throat, and she leaned back harder into me.

Which was extremely satisfying. Until I felt the duvet cover slipping, and we both went backward and onto the floor.

This could have been a very dangerous thing, so if you're laughing, don't. My cock could have gotten bent or crushed, the way this all went down. Natalie flopped onto the floor next to me, and there was a slightly horrible crunch of her knees or ankles crashing together.

“Natalie!” I said, and I'll admit that my concern for her, the way she was curled up in a fetal position and heaving silently, her hair covering her face, came after I looked down to make sure that I had escaped the commotion... er... un-crumpled myself.

I pulled on her shoulder, and my wife unfolded from her curled position. Her hair slipped away from her face, which was bright red like she was choking.

But she was laughing. Laughing so hard she couldn't breathe.

When she was finally able to take a breath, she gave a huge snort.

I was laughing, too, then, and I suppose that's why there was never a serious conversation about what had just transpired. We watched trashy, reality TV while we drank some more wine and we didn't fall asleep until four am.

As I mentioned, Natalie knew a little about my sexual fantasies. At least, she wouldn't have fallen over from the shock of it if she ran into a hotwifing porno on my computer, or someone said to her: “Hey I think your husband fantasizes about you with another man.”

She just didn't seem to really believe they were as... well, real as they were. Which is fair, because I wasn't sure exactly how real they were, either.

It was a long road from when these fantasies started for me, which was pretty much from my first girlfriend, to being able to even enjoy them inside my own mind by myself. Let alone being able to voice them, however “fantastically,” to my wife.

When I first started having thoughts about my first girlfriend, Jessica, making out with some other guy, I'd dismissed it as pure jealousy and insecurity. Just another moving, incomprehensible part of the obsession I had with women when I was an adolescent.

Or, that's how I like to frame it now. I was a fucking teenager; I didn't know myself and I probably didn't have a single thought that coherent in my head. But I do remember those ideas percolating up inside of my mind, and I remember actively chasing them away.

I think I figured those thoughts would eventually go away, like a few other curiosities I had at the time. But with each successive relationship, and in fact the more profound my relationships became, the more that kind of thought – of watching that girl with another guy - would spring up in my head.

It took me a while to even be brave enough to admit to myself, in spite of all the... well, hard evidence... that thoughts about my girlfriends sleeping with other men was a sexual turn-on for me.

I grew up in a small-ish town in South Carolina that only recently got swallowed up by the growing city and became a "gentrified" suburb. Back in school, boys were boys or they got stomped on, so even if you weren't a particularly swashbuckling football-playing tobacco-spitting gongo-head, you sure as hell acted like you were unless you wanted your ass kicked. I had the good fortune (or bad, depending on how you look at it) of being Ethan Cooke's next-door neighbor, and he always took a shining to me. So I was pulled into the circle of jocks, and I assume they would have given me a lot more shit had Ethan not been the consummate alpha-male. It helped that I could catch a ball and run really fast with it.

The point of all this is that if you had a thought in your head like, "I'd like to see my girlfriend fuck another guy," or anything else off the well-beaten Traditional Testosterone Path, you kept it the fuck to yourself.

I went to community college for a year, and then university on my academic merits. Ethan went to the same school on his athletic merits, so our orbits slowly teased themselves apart. Free of his Jupiter-sized gravitational pull, I got to thinking on my own. Watching my girlfriends when they interacted with other men, feeling it pulse through my cock, lying awake after having sex or going home and allowing myself to think about. Think about it for the sheer pleasure of it. Think about it because *I liked it*.

I don't have any idea why it took me so long to turn to the internet. I wasn't really a porn guy beyond the average porn-swapping. Ethan's buddies were always shoving it in my face, and I watched because it was there or someone gave it to me, so there was really never any need to go find it myself. I was a good-looking guy, athletic, and I didn't spend a lot of time being lonely.

When I got to college I really had better things to do – real girls to chase, an identity to carve out.

But eventually, I found myself out there, searching for what it was I wanted, not really knowing what that was.

And I found it.

What a nice revelation it was, that day I stumbled onto a whole universe of porn centered around the idea that there were men out there –

and lots of them, by the look of it – who enjoyed watching their girlfriends (and to my shock, I guess, wives) fuck other guys.

It wasn't so much that the porn was really great. It wasn't, in fact, because the whole thing about this fetish is that it has to be *your* girlfriend, and so it was pretty hard to get some porn going that dug into me the same way. What was great was the realization that this was not just some fucked up thing in my own mind. There were a lot of guys out there who got off to their wives and girlfriends fucking someone else.

For a while, in fact, all the way through to the first two years' of my marriage, I was satisfied with just enjoying that *fantasy* for myself. A weight had been lifted, in the sense that I now felt free to just enjoy the fantasy instead of worrying about why I was having it. I didn't even really consider actually *talking* to my wife about it.

But like everything does, I guess, my thrills sort of faded, and I decided I wanted something more. Well, a bottle of wine and I decided together that I wanted something more.

It happened one night when Natalie and I got into a little bit of an argument because I had too much to drink when I was supposed to be driving, and we had to take a cab home. While I had gone outside to have a smoke and clear my head, I'd watched a the husband of a friend of hers, whose party we were at, console her. But yeah, *that kind* of consolation.

The very friendly, very back-rubby kind.

It sent me into a weird rage of both jealousy and desire.

When we got home, I hadn't known what to do with myself. I'd done the lashing out (“You and Dave sure seemed to be hitting it off,”) and that had elicited an eye-roll from Natalie. And then I can hardly say what happened, but she ended up saying something like, “Oh you'd like that, wouldn't you?” and we'd played a little game.

And... we hadn't talked about it after that.

But maybe the third time something like that happened, Natalie asked me about it the next day:

“So what's up with the 'you're flirting with other guys,' thing?”

The first feeling to fill my arteries was cold-as-ice fear.

I shrugged.

“I don't know. It's just... I don't know. Kind of hot.”

Inside I remember thinking I was a huge fucking idiot. Why didn't I have anything to say to her? Of course she was going to ask this, eventually.

A note on Natalie of this era: Natalie was a really smart girl, as I said, who had been in that fancy-ass bachelor's program. This was a science-based program, and Natalie had been this girl who wore crazy dresses and died her hair deep magenta and preferred to spend all her time painting emotionally disturbing stuff. So, don't let the next bit of this narration take you completely by surprise:

She leaned over me and took a cigarette out of a pack that had fallen on the floor.

I slapped her hand.

"I'm not going to *smoke it*," she said, rolling her eyes. She put it between her lips and pretended to smoke. "I just feel like I should be doing this if we're having such a deep conversation." She smiled. "Just tell me what it is you like about it," she said.

When I didn't answer, she added: "I'm sorry, it just seems pretty weird to me."

I shrugged again. I had spent – well, zero minutes articulating "what I liked about it" to myself in words. I had no answer.

"I don't know," I said. I felt pretty exposed and sort of wished we weren't having the conversation. "It's just... hot."

Natalie was looking at me, at that moment, with such a strange look on her face, that I felt the need to say quickly – very quickly - "Purely as a fantasy. You know? I would never actually... want you to... you know."

Natalie fake-ashed her fake-cigarette. She gave this some thought. "Huh," she said. Then, she looked up at the ceiling. "Yeah. I can see that."

She hopped out of bed at that point, and began to shimmy on her underwear.

"See *what*?" I had to ask. For some reason, her response was really... bothering me, though couldn't say exactly how or why.

"Just..." she pulled a t-shirt on and shook her hair out. "I have stuff like that, you know? Things I think about and wouldn't actually want to do. So I think I get it."

Two roads diverged into a wood, and I took the well-lit one:

"Like what?"

"Huh?"

"Things you think about. Like what? When?"

What I should have done is clarify to her that this was something slightly different. I should have asked any other number of questions at that

moment, but this is what my brain had come up with.

Natalie slid into her jeans. "Oh, you mean fantasies?"

"Yeah."

She had hopped on the bed and playfully crawled toward me to kiss me on the lips. "Like, private, secret things I like to think about inside of my own head, privately?"

"Yeah."

She hopped away. "They're private."

I simmered in bed for a few minutes after she left the room. I knew I didn't really have any good reason or right to be as incensed as I was with her at that moment, but I was. After a good long think, I realized that her refusal to share her private fantasies after I'd told her about mine really irked me, but then again, I had never asked her for a *quid pro quo*.

But the thing that had really gotten under my skin was that Natalie took me at my word, so easily and with so much conviction, that watching her with another man was just a fantasy I didn't really want to *actually* indulge in. I was angry with myself for jumping in and saying that, and not letting her offer up her own opinion. I had trapped myself into this position, of Natalie thinking I didn't really want to live out the fantasy, and I had no idea if really playing it out would appeal to her or not.

I stewed on all of this for a while, and then I had an epiphany:

I was upset by the conversation because deep down inside, I didn't think of the fantasy as just a fantasy. Deep down inside, I *did* want to make it real.

This realization terrified me, so I set the whole idea on the back burner and tried not to think about it. I had a good thing in Natalie. She was pretty, loyal, fun, and smart. I loved her, and she loved me. Why would I want to risk all of that for a sexual fantasy that I wasn't even 100% sure I wanted?

Having kids sort of put a lid on everything anyway. Natalie let her hair grow out plain brown, started painting commercially-viable art pieces, started worrying more about what daycare and preschool to get the kids into than anything else. Life centered around all of that for such a long time that by the time the kids were old enough for us to have some remnant of our old lives back, we were not the same people anymore.

I remember having that thought, some time in the year before the reunion. The kids were away at the grandparents, we had gone out for

dinner, a waiter had flirted with her shamelessly after asking to see her ID when she ordered wine with dinner. I had a thought about indulging in my fantasy, bringing the waiter up, having a night like the ones we had abandoned so long ago. Natalie was standing by the window, peeling a white camisole away from her body. When I looked at her reflection in the mirror, I had the strangest feeling. Like this was not the person I had married, and I barely knew her.

We made love that night, and it was good. But there was no way I was bringing up the dark things that lurked in my mind with this angelic, brown-haired girl who drove the kids to soccer and still tucked the little guy into bed.

So that was that.

Until the reunion.

CHAPTER 3: SURPRISES

Two weeks later, I was back at work and beleaguered in my office with the usual overflow of papers. I'm a contract and small-claims lawyer. It's boring as hell.

There's no point going into further detail.

I answered my phone one afternoon, convinced it was my paralegal Sandy, calling to tell me if she was able to file in Lexington. The courts were overflowing, and filing had to be done in person with originals, but half the time no one was there to do it.

"Yeah?"

The papers I had been juggling slipped out of the folder and I watched them slide, like slow-motion lava, toward a half-full coffee cup on my desk.

"Erik?"

The voice paralyzed me. The papers continued, impacted the Styrofoam, and the cup tipped. Then tipped some more.

"Shit." I dropped a file and reached for the cup. Too late. The Styrofoam popped on the table and the coffee poured out.

Directly. Into. My briefcase.

"Hey, man, you busy? It's Ethan."

"Ethan?" I forgot all about the coffee. I held the phone away from my face. Local number. "You in Yorkdale?"

"You sound busy, man. I can call you later."

I looked into the briefcase. "Just knocked a... no, it's cool." I found myself reverting to the speech of my early twenties. It felt silly, but I couldn't stop myself. "No... but, where are you? You here?"

There was a long pause.

"Yeah, listen. I'm wondering if we can get a beer or something."

I surveyed the scene. My eyes went to the clock. "Now?"

Ethan's laugh, a sort of wild-boar sound, hissed through the phone. "No, man, Jesus. What are you, in high school? No, later. Can you get away tonight?"

"You're here?" I said, buying myself some time. It was Tuesday, for fuck's sake. And what Ethan even doing here? He hadn't been back to South Carolina for years.

“Yeah. How about Shoppy's. Eight o'clock?”

“I...”

“See you then.”

And he was gone.

“Ethan?” Natalie's voice said, sounding as nonplussed as mine through the phone. “Like, from our trip, Ethan?”

“Yeah,” I said.

A pause, and I tried to imagine the face Natalie was making.

“What's he doing here? I thought he never came back?”

I shrugged, and then I realized she couldn't see me. “I don't know.” I sounded slightly exasperated. I was gearing up for Natalie to put up a big fight, and half of me wanted her to so I could legitimately not go see Ethan, while the other half didn't want to deal with explaining that I really should. And those halves were further divided into more complicated thoughts, like whether or not I *should* feel obligated to see Ethan. On and on.

Natalie was no help whatsoever in sorting any of this out when she said: “God. He's a mess. You should just go out with him.”

I had no idea what had gone in Natalie's mind in the two seconds between my sentence and hers. “I... what? Are you sure?”

She paused. “Yeah. Just.. whatever, just go out with him, he's probably not in town that long. I can take care of things here. Or are you coming home for dinner first?”

I looked into my briefcase again. “I poured some coffee into my briefcase,” I said. “So I think I'll be... I'll just go from here?”

I was still confused by the lack of “discussion” about this whole thing.

“Okay,” Natalie said cheerfully.

“Okay,” I said, much more guarded.

“See you when you get home.”

I mentally scanned her voice for any trace of passive-aggression, and finding none, I reluctantly agreed. “O... kay.”

“Don't go to any strip clubs,” she cautioned. (I had, somewhere along the way, filled her in on Ethan's proclivities for dirty Southern stripclubs).

“He wants to meet at a bar,” I assured her.

Which, come to think of it, was also very strange.

Natalie smacked a kiss into the phone. And hung up.

Shopy's was a dive fifteen years ago when we were in high school, and I hadn't even driven by the place in over a decade. But, there it was, as if nothing had ever happened between then and now. The same dirty, beige adobe walls outside, the same Standard Blue Collar Man's Bar Decor inside. There was a crack of pool balls as I stepped into the dim space, which still reeked of all the cigarettes that had ever been smoked in the joint. Which were many – and some more recently than the smoking ban might have indicated.

Ethan was hunched over a beer, and he would have looked like the pathetic guys next to him – old-timers, the permanent fixtures of any establishment like Shopy's – except that he was far younger, far better-looking, and, even though he had dressed down to a sweatshirt, he was still slicked over with his money. He also looked like he ate something besides bar peanuts, which was probably the only non-alcoholic item in the rest of the guys' diets.

He looked up and saw me, and stood up to meet me on my side of the bar – no way he was getting any of those guys to move. He brightened a little in an interaction with the bartender, a bottle-blond whose name escaped me, but the same one who had served us beers underage fifteen years ago. Underage beer had been the only appeal of Shopy's back then, because the bartender – a battle ax ten years ago and even meaner-looking now – was the only woman in the place. A beer materialized in front of me as soon as I sat down. “From your buddy Ethan there,” her smokey voice told me.

Ethan hugged me this time. Almost a little too long.

“Hey man,” I said. “What's up? What're you doing here?”

“This place,” Ethan said, ignoring my question and swinging himself around for a look around the bar, “has not changed at all.”

I braced myself for a trip down memory lane, which included such great events as Ethan headbutting three bikers and me thinking I was going to die, and Ethan hitting on some neo-Nazi's girlfriend and me thinking I was going to die, and me talking the cops out of arresting Ethan after he called them “pig-faced pig-fucking pigs” when they tried to remove him from the bar because he was naked... and me thinking I was going to die.

Good times.

"I'm getting a divorce," he said, and the sentence was so heavy it crushed all the sound in the room for a moment.

I was still taking my coat off. I stopped, the sleeves still caught on my arms.

"What?" I said.

This was my first conversation of this type. I'm a pretty touchy-feely guy, or so I'm told, but I don't have a ton of social engagements anymore. I was sort of hoping to escape my thirties without ever having to do this, and yet here I was, getting divorce-bombed two years in.

I sat.

"Man. Ethan. That's... rough."

I also had no idea what to say because Ethan just being *married* had been such a shock to my psyche that Ethan getting *divorced* actually seemed to be a return to normalcy.

He shook his head. "It's all my own fault, you know? I really had a good thing with Moira, and I just didn't... I don't even know what happened. I didn't spend enough time with her, or something."

I pressed my lips together.

"Uh... is it really... like, it's really over?" I was sorry I said this the minute I said it. It sounded so idiotic.

Ethan just sighed miserably.

I put my hand on his back and clapped it a few times. It's not that I'm an insensitive guy, it's just that I was realizing at that moment that I no longer knew Ethan at all and I had no idea how to console him. He seemed *really*, genuinely upset by his divorce, which wasn't anything the Ethan I had known in the past would be feeling. *That* Ethan never would have gotten married to begin with.

Ethan turned and looked at me. "I'm sorry man," he said, like he had read my thoughts. "We haven't been in touch for so long. Sorry to dump all this on you." He took a sip of his beer. "I just... realized with all this, I didn't have any real friends. You know? It's been this big epiphany, things falling apart, seeing who was left, who stuck by me..."

It was then that I realized Ethan was really, really drunk.

I sucked in my breath. It was ill-advised but I bought him another shot, which he made me have also. One more and I'd be cabbing it to be on the safe side.

I cringed inwardly when Ethan raised his finger at the bartender.

“So... is this why you're back in Yorkdale?”

Ethan looked up at the ceiling and inhaled. “I don't know. I don't know man. I'm kinda thinking about moving home.” A pause. “I'm fuckin' broke.”

I raised my eyebrows.

Ethan didn't elaborate: it was easy enough to see how it might have happened. Rich people always seemed more “broke” at the end of a divorce. It was all relative though, and I could vouch for that, handling small claims in Yorkdale, South Carolina. I had a client on a \$20/month payment plan for a \$10,000 bill because it was all she could do.

We had another shot and Ethan launched on a monologue that was so slow, branching, and drunken I feel compelled to just summarize it here. It was also such a classic, and by that I mean cliché, that it almost hurt to listen to: he lost love and he realized there's more to life than money, he was back home to see if there was a way to stay here, change his life, get back in touch with what really matters.

“Like you and Natalie,” he slurred, at the end of his diatribe. He was well, well into the bottle, having had two or three shots for my every one (and I was in the bag). “I want... something like... you and Natalie...”

“Okay, bud,” I said. “Let's get you home. Where are you staying?”

I started to dial a cab, because no matter what the answer was, I wasn't driving.

Ethan turned to me. His eyes were red-rimmed, and he was looking pretty pathetic. Somehow, he had made me feel sorry for him, and that wasn't a feeling I'd ever, ever had for Ethan. “I don't know what I'm gonna do,” he said. “I'm sleeping in a fucking hotel!” He pointed at the ceiling, which I assumed meant he was staying in the three-room dive above Shoppy's.

Pretty grim.

“I have no money,” he went on. “I have no friends.”

At this point he was sort of yelling, the way drunk people do. People at the bar were looking over, but as far as Shoppy's went it was a mild disturbance, fairly boring, and not really causing a scene. But it was headed there.

I've dealt with a lot of drunks in my life, so I should have known better than to do what I did next. “Look, Ethan, man, it's not true. I'm your friend. I'm... hey, I have an idea.”

I had an idea because I was, as I discovered when I stood up ten minutes later, much drunker than I thought I was. Ethan bear hugged me out to the cab, and we said goodbye.

And about two minutes into the cab ride, the world closed in on me, and all the things I'd just said and done came into sharp relief.

“Fuck,” I said, aloud.

The kids were asleep by the time I got home, and Natalie was in the kitchen, assembly-line packaging lunches and soccer snacks and other school-related items. When I came through the door of the laundry room to the kitchen, she turned her body halfway and smiled at me, one hand holding a knife still in a jar of mayonnaise. “How'd it go?”

I was relieved she didn't seem to be annoyed by the late hour, because I had little shards of guilt floating around in my head about it. “Good,” I said, and the word was pregnant, more like a question. “I, uh... had to take a cab.”

“Oh, *really* good, then,” she joked.

I squinted at her. What was with the good mood?

“Because I was drunk,” I said. I wasn't sure why I was trying to provoke her, but I really wanted her to act normally, just so I could confirm I wasn't dreaming this.

She looked me up and down. “You don't say.”

Back to the mayo.

I sat down on a barstool at the kitchen island. “So, you were right about Ethan and Moira,” I began.

Natalie slapped some mayonnaise on a piece of bread and turned around to face me as she spread it. “Oh yeah? How so?”

Natalie had been in a decidedly better mood since we had traveled to Chicago. Perhaps “better mood” is the wrong word for it. “Rejuvenated mood” might be closer to what she was. She moved playfully, did things like what she was doing now, leaning on the counter with one hip slightly elevated, showing off the curves of her body. I got a little twitch of arousal just watching her bounce around and dip a knife into the mayonnaise in a way that was... I don't know how to explain it. More sexual? She got another piece of bread and turned back to look at me while she spread the mayo.

I was really reluctant to put a wrench in the whole thing.

“Uh...” I scratched my head. I changed the subject. “Do we have any beer?”

To my surprise, Natalie's eyes lit up. “What a great idea. On a Tuesday? So *sinful*.” She dropped the bread and hopped to the refrigerator. “Let's see...”

I watched her ass as she bent over and dug into the fridge. She was wearing her usual get-up: a matching sporty outfit made of stretchy material, with a top that hugged her hips and her torso. The pants weren't ultra-tight, but when she *did* bend over, they gave a very nice silhouette of the shape of her ass. I had a flashback of our non-missionary lovemaking in Chicago, and I felt myself get a little hard.

But then a pang of anxiety came barreling through my pleasant thoughts. I still had to talk to her about Ethan.

Or did I?

I didn't really *owe* Ethan anything. He had been a good friend, and I was certain that my life had been easier in high school because of his unyielding loyalty to me. But he had also had me under his thumb in a lot of ways, and it made me squirm a little to think about the way he had been sort of a pack-leader or an alpha-ape, and we had all fallen in line behind him.

I could just tell Ethan that Natalie had nixed the idea. The idea I'd idiotically had in the final moments at the bar.

The idea that led me to tell Ethan that he could stay with us in the summer, while the kids were gone to their grandparents' for a month.

It wasn't as simple, in case you're thinking this, as just pretending it had never happened (Ethan had an obnoxiously good memory while he was drunk), or saying that I'd asked Natalie when in fact I hadn't. Because there was more at work in my own mind and heart than just underestimating my drunkenness and becoming philanthropic for ten minutes.

There was a pull inside of me to get Ethan into the house. It came in part from loyalty to Ethan, sure. But part of it came from a much darker place. The kind of place where we'd gone to, purely in fantasy, back in Chicago.

And *that*, I had told myself a hundred times, was not a good reason to let Ethan stay at my house.

But it was still under my skin.

Natalie turned around, shaking two mismatched beers in her hand lightly. “I have... oh, God. Stella and Coors Light.” She frowned. “I will

give you the Stella, because I am a good person and you seem to have had a bad day.”

She set it in front of me. “Now dish the dirt.”

I stood up. “I need a bottle opener.”

And a few more seconds to make a decision about what I was going to do.

I sat back down, and twisted the cap off her Coors Light when she tilted it toward me. “Thanks,” she said. “So...?”

“Well...”

“They're getting a divorce, right?” she interjected. “I knew it.” She took a sip of her beer. “That's why he's back here.”

“Well, yeah...”

Natalie nodded. “You can always *tell*,” she said.

I looked at her, trying to gauge what she was thinking. She seemed almost... happy. I let my thoughts meander a bit, wondering if she was happy because she secretly wanted Ethan to get a divorce so that she could have a chance with him, but as soon as I thought about for a few seconds it seemed preposterous.

Natalie was just happy because she had been right about a hunch. She loved that.

“So, what? He's back and he's going to get in touch with his Southern roots? Buy a farm, marry a nice Carolina belle, be the male version of... what's that movie with... what's-her-face, the blonde girl, who went back to Alabama? Not Drew Barrymore but...”

I knew the movie she was thinking of, (*Sweet Home Alabama*, with Reese Witherspoon), but I wasn't about to insult my own male pride by remembering a chick flick for my wife. Besides, it was funny that she couldn't figure it out.

“Anyway,” she said. “Is that his plan?”

“Well,” I said, and then I took a sip of beer to buy myself just a *tiny bit* more time. I looked at the table and made a face that I could actually *see* in my own mind. It's the look all men make right before they tell their wives something like what I was about to tell my wife. I make it by grimacing, and squinting at the same time. “He's... yeah, that's actually *sort of* the plan, the thing is, he's, uh... he's sort of broke. And, he is wondering if... okay, first of all I just want to say, this is all your veto, I'll go with whatever you want, and I told him it would only work while the kids are at your mom's,

but he wants to just come back and get a feel for whether or not he wants to move back, whether he can, and he kind of... needs a place to stay.”

I looked up. Natalie, at that moment, had the beer bottle in her mouth, with her lips around it in a way that was provocative without her meaning it to be. She paused with the glass puffing out her lips like a cock, and looked at me sideways. She popped the bottle from her lips, and the liquid swished noisily.

“He what?”

I shrugged. “He asked if he could stay here. Look, he has a lot of other friends, I think he just came to me first because...”

I thought back on the conversation. Truthfully, I had offered.

The thing is, it didn't *feel* like I had offered. Ethan had that effect on people. And the truth was, I could feel it inside of me: I wanted Natalie to say yes.

I really wanted Ethan to be taking a shower in my house while Natalie was home. I really wanted to see the two of them interact, I really wanted to feel the queasy, unsubtle arousal of being so dangerously close to having my wife get fucked by another man, especially a man like Ethan, especially if I could watch the whole thing unfold. It was deliciously appealing to me.

Natalie set her beer down. She was looking at the table. I wondered what she was thinking. I found myself hoping she was thinking about the same dangerous ideas I was. I found myself getting wound up, in every sense, thinking that *she* might have the same ideas I did. Or even be open to them.

My heart was beating absurdly fast. With every second of thrilling thoughts, I was more and more hopeful that Natalie could somehow be convinced to say yes to this idea, and even more terrified of it as well.

It was a *bad* idea. Bad the way cocaine was a bad idea. Bad like cigarettes. Bad like ruin-your-marriage thrill.

“I don't know...” Natalie said. She was extremely noncommittal in her tone. Her eyes fluttered back up to me, and I noticed she was moving her hands on the countertop, a tick of Natalie's when she is hiding something. She says one thing but she can't stop her hands from drawing a picture. Fortunately for Natalie, her expressive art is so abstract that no one would be able to get at her secret by watching what she does with her hands. It's just a tell that she's got something else going on inside her head.

I found myself saying “the right thing.”

“Look, I know, it's a big imposition. I told him I'd ask, I figured you'd say no, and it's cool.”

We looked at each other. There was actually enough tension – really good, really gut-twisting tension – between us to cut it with a knife. I don't know what it was that was churning around inside of Natalie, but I hoped it was a feeling that Ethan was a dangerous element to let into her house, but one that she sort of wanted to give a try.

My eyes dropped to Natalie's chest. She was breathing a little more rapidly than before.

“Or...” I said. “What were you thinking?”

Natalie shook her head pretty quickly. Her eyes dropped to her hands again, and as soon as she saw them moving all over the place, she quieted them and put them in her lap. “I mean, I don't want to be the... uptight wife. There's no real reason he *couldn't*... I guess. If the kids aren't here.”

There were plenty of reasons that I could think of that Ethan *shouldn't* stay here.

“Well... thanks,” I said, lacking any other response. My heart felt cold and hot at the same time. I was innervated, I felt like the world was buzzing and more alive. The prospect of Ethan actually coming here, staying in my house, being so close to my wife, maybe tempting her... it was giving me a high.

A bad feeling was lurking somewhere around there, too.

It always is, when you're doing something you know you shouldn't.

Natalie smiled at me. “Yeah,” she said, as if reassuring herself. She had the same quiver in her voice as when we had purchased an expensive new car a few years back. She had spent about twenty minutes talking herself into it after we parked it in the garage and it was far too late to do anything about it. “It'll be fun. There isn't any reason we can't help the guy out. Maybe he can... I don't know. Is he handy? Maybe he can do some of the stuff on your 'honey-do' list. Or no, that would be rude. I wonder which room we should give him?” Natalie stood up and opened the fridge, and she kept babbling on and on, which was the sort of thing she did when she had a thought in her head that she really wanted to cover up. She covered it up with layers and layers of out-loud thinking. It was pretty transparent, and cute, because Natalie never thought out loud otherwise.

The question was: what thoughts was she trying to bury?

I hoped they were thoughts about Ethan, at the same time that I sincerely hoped they weren't.

And so, just like that, it was pretty much done.

“O..kay..” I said. “I’ll... tell him that’s fine.”

“*After* the kids leave for mom’s.”

“Okay.”

And that was that.

CHAPTER 4: MOVES

Natalie stood in the doorway of the house, leaning against the frame and watching us move Ethan's things from a U-Haul into the house and the garage. When Ethan had shown up with a U-Haul, her mouth had turned slightly down – not something noticeable to a person who didn't know her very well, but noticeable to me. The mild frown had not disappeared in the last ten minutes.

I was also a little shocked that Ethan had so much stuff. I hadn't talked to him about it, but I had sort of assumed “staying at my place for a bit” involved a suitcase or two, not furniture.

It was just like Ethan, though, to show up with a full dining set and tell you he was going to put it in your garage (“if that's okay, buddy”) without ever deigning to ask ahead of time.

And it was just like me to not have the balls to say no.

There was some mild unpleasantness, then, but there were also very pleasant things.

Natalie had put on a pair of shorts for the day. They were the first pair of the summer, and I noticed with both pleasure and a little bit of suspicion (the pleasant kind) that she had chosen the shortest and most flattering pair she owned: a pair of high-cut cutoffs that framed her round ass perfectly and let a great deal of her toned thighs dangle from the ripped cuffs. It also seemed to me that she had more of a tan than should be possible at the beginning of summer. She was also wearing a very pretty crocheted teal top, one I'd never seen before. The holes in the torso of the top showed little snippets of her tummy. A pair of matching crocheted teal shoes, in a wedge or whatever girls called that kind of heel, lengthened her legs obscenely. They tied around her ankles with a ribbon in a very unpractical and sexy way. She seemed to have put her hair in a “casual” pony-tail to hide the fact that she had, quite obviously, dressed up a little for Ethan. She had black mascara on and her lips were a little pink.

Ethan waved at her from the curb, and said some drawly Southern thing like, “Hello, there darlin” but otherwise ignored her as we put the furniture away. This filled me with both relief and mild disappointment, and

Natalie standing in the door with a frown helped to volley me back and forth between those feelings.

We put the dining set in the garage.

“Remember this?” Ethan said, tapping on the surface with his knuckles. “This was my mom's set. No way Moira was keeping this.”

There were a few more antique items that were evidently Ethan's mother's, like a dresser and a wardrobe. I was thankful that the U-Haul was half-empty and cleared out pretty quickly.

We started on the boxes and a few huge Duffel bags and suitcases, as well as an extensive collection of suit bags filled with Ethan's high-power hedge fund outfits.

And that's when Ethan turned up the charm. He walked past Natalie, and paused in the doorway, next to her. “Sweetheart don't let all this stuff turn your smile sour, you won't even notice me.”

His accent seemed to have gone full-throttle charm.

It wasn't so much what Ethan said to women. There was something else to it. I'd been an avid observer of Ethan all my life, because I really wanted to narrow in on the secret of his charms.

I watched Natalie's face. She took a small step backward and looked down, trying to hide the smile that was creeping into her expression. Ethan's eyes did a quick sweep over her body, lingering on her legs, and he let out a low whistle. “Lookin' good, Mrs. Ossington.” He shifted the box in his hands and strolled into the house. A few steps in we both heard him say, in a low voice to no one in particular: “I *do* love summer.”

Natalie looked up at me. I could see that the compliment had an effect on her, that her cheeks had flushed a little and her downturned mouth was now re-set to smiling. I shrugged and smiled nervously. “That's Ethan for you,” I said, as I walked past her with another, smaller box. I paused to give her a kiss. “I'm sorry,” I whispered. “I didn't know he had all this junk.”

Natalie shrugged as well, as if the matter were out of her hands. “It's... fine. Uh... you guys want some sandwiches maybe?”

“I *want* sandwiches,” Ethan called from the guest bedroom, the room around the stairs at the front of the house where we had decided to put him.

Natalie grinned at me, a sort of lopsided expression halfway between exasperation and genuine amusement. This was a common sentiment among people who were around Ethan for any period of time.

He started singing, making Natalie smile even more, in spite of herself. She looked down as she pushed herself away from the doorframe and went into the kitchen to make sandwiches, as Ethan belted out a song about sandwiches that was moderately vulgar.

Very suddenly, my mood shifted. I felt unsettled. The Ethan of our Chicago visit seemed to be peeling away in the baking South Carolinian heat. His attention-grabbing personality seemed to have grown stronger along with his accent, and he was more like the Ethan I used to know. Alpha-Ethan, ladykiller, philanderer, charmer.

I wasn't sure what door I had opened.

We had sandwiches without incident, other than Ethan's unrepentant gazing at Natalie's legs, and then he took off to return the U-Haul. He came home fairly late.

He put on his nonchalant, aloof act.

I was pretty sure Ethan was doing this on purpose. It was part of his schtick: charm and then show disinterest, until women came flocking to him.

Natalie had shrugged, and gone to bed right after he came home, taking all the air out his nonchalance, if it was in fact an act. This gave me a certain amount of pleasure as well: if Ethan *was* trying to lure her to him, she didn't seem to be taking the bait. I also knew that women who ignored Ethan's advances focused his attention like a laser right on themselves. My mood swung again, to buoyant. This would be fun, watching the two of them interact. Good clean fun.

I had a beer with him, and a dull conversation about driving from Chicago to Yorkdale. He ended it abruptly, declaring that he was going out, which probably meant to a stripclub.

Natalie was in bed, propped up on a pillow, a magazine in her hand. This was definitely for show, because it was *Newsweek*, which did not interest her in any way.

She let it fall to her lap when I came in.

We looked at each other.

"Well," I said. "That's Ethan."

We could still hear him moving around in the house, getting ready to go out.

Natalie leaned forward a little. “Is he really going out? On a Tuesday?” she whispered, a strange little grin on her face.

I sat down on my side of the bed and leaned over, across her legs. “That'd be Ethan,” I said. “A real ladies' man.”

Natalie shook her head a little, a gesture of disbelief and admiration. “He's quite the charmer,” she purred.

There was a glint in her eyes.

I was already mildly turned on by everything that had transpired that day. I didn't waste any time wondering if I should take advantage of the open door here. The glint in Natalie's eyes had a film of sexuality to it. I reached over with my free hand and ran my fingertips over the top of her thigh.

She had changed into her standard summertime pajama outfit: a pair of clingy cotton shorts, and a tank top. This pair was light pink, edged with a little bit of lace at the bottom of the shorts and the neckline of the tank top. “He's *very* charming,” I said, moving my hand up to the edge of her shorts and exploring, just a little, beneath the material.

Her skin was warm, and beneath the fabric it was a number of degrees hotter. Her eyes dropped to my fingers, and her mouth twitched a little. I probed further, finding the crease where her thigh met her hips. Her skin was a little sticky with the humidity and heat. I slid my finger down the crease and toward the center of her legs. “It seems like his charms even worked on you,” I suggested.

Natalie tossed her hair a little defiantly. Her mouth formed a strange smile. “Oh, it does, does it?” she said. She pulled the Newsweek away and let it fall to the floor.

I slipped my fingers over her downy bush, which she had apparently just trimmed up – and believe me, my mind went directly to the same place it had when I saw her skimpy summer outfit. It *could* just be coincidence, but it *seemed* like she had put a lot of time and effort into her appearance, every layer of it, more so than usual, *right on the day that Ethan had arrived*.

I lowered my head and kissed the top of her thigh as I dipped into the folds of her pussy.

A shudder went through me as my fingers grew immediately warm and wet. It wasn't at all like Natalie to be so worked up just sitting there waiting for me to come to bed. Something (or *someone*) had her worked up,

and I was both dying to confirm that it was Ethan, and inwardly horrified by the idea that it might actually be Ethan. My heart started to race. I pressed on her clit, and her lips parted. I looked up at her, and watched her face as I stroked her clit.

“Interesting,” I said, and there was no doubt what I was referring to.

Natalie didn't say anything, she just let her breath escape through her slightly open lips as I stroked her button. Her cunt was soaked, and her juices began to coat my fingers all the way to the knuckles. She squirmed a little underneath me, beneath my fingers.

“Last chance to come out, y'all,” Ethan called from the hallway, but he didn't wait for our answer. We heard his footsteps. “See you, then.” His wide smile was evident in his voice.

Natalie and I didn't stop looking at each other. I kept rubbing her, and she was melting in my hands. The door slammed, and I wasted no time in hopping on top of her, straddling her wriggling body. I used two hands to jerk her boy-shorts down. With a brief glance I saw that she had, indeed, trimmed herself up into a tidy landing strip. The lips of her glistening cunt were waxed bare. I raised my eyebrows, and she flushed a little. “What? It's summer,” she said.

Her words seared through me. I'd think about it later, I didn't at the time, but the fact that she was making an excuse for having done something she *did* do regularly in the summer was interesting to say the least. It was dripping with just the perfect amount of guilt, and she had revealed to me that she felt a little guilty. The only reason for that would be... that there had been some thought in her head, that some part of her reasons for doing it on that particular day had to do with Ethan.

“Looks great,” I said. I let her know with my tone of voice that I'd registered her guilt, and I hoped she understood it was okay.

It was more than okay.

My cock throbbed. Natalie reached down and pushed her pajamas down her legs, shimmying and squirming to get them off while I fumbled with my pants. Straddling her like that, all I could do was let my cock spring out of my boxers, and I was thinking about where to go next, when Natalie reached for me and held me with two hands, squeezing my cock firmly.

“It'll be so nice to have another big, strong man around the house,” Natalie said, her eyes on my cock. “Ethan said he'd be happy to help out.”

She released her grip on my dick and used the palm of one hand to rub the top of my shaft, her eyes on it absent-mindedly. She seemed to actually be imagining all the things that Ethan could “do around the house” for her.

My cock pulsed, and she smiled. She lifted her eyes to meet mine. Her fingers played with the crown of my cock, spreading out to the rim and then closing up, brushing lightly over the crown, at the very tip, like the motion of a jellyfish, again and again. She did this while she spoke, her eyes obviously delighting each time she made me flex or twitch.

“I figure I could make him some lemonade,” she said. “It gets so hot in the summer, and he said he'd work on that shed first thing. We'll both be dripping with sweat.”

I imagined Natalie in the outfit she'd worn today, perching in the doorway of the shed with a tray of lemonade. Setting it down, taking an ice cube out of a glass and placing it on her neck, sliding it from the hollow of her throat to her breasts, the melted liquid running beneath her shirt in rivers. Ethan watching, unabashedly taking in the sight, the way only Ethan could.

Natalie's fingers grew sticky with the precum that boiling out of my cock.

“It'll be very tempting to have a man like that around,” she purred. “All that extra time, and nothing to do...”

“And what would you and Ethan get up to?” I croaked. I had intentions of being a little more subtle, but I was hungry now and I didn't care.

Natalie smiled. “It's probably not the sort of thing I should tell my husband,” she said.

Natalie's fingers at the tip of my cock were no longer satisfying me. The length of my shaft was crying out to be enveloped in any part of her. I edged up and reached behind her head to guide her mouth to my cock. “Would you suck Ethan's cock while I was work?” I said.

Her lips were very close to the tip of my dick, and she stuck her tongue out and licked the head with the blade of her tongue. Her mouth was as wet as her cunt, and she moved her head slightly left and right to get the flat of her tongue to slide over my glans. It was such a dirty, un-tidy, slobbery way to tease me. She looked so whoreish that a whole new wave of lust came over me. I pulled on her hair as I gripped her head more tightly. I pushed my cock into her mouth, and she moved her head toward

me at the same time, so I was instantly buried in her mouth halfway down my shaft. I pushed on her head, and dove deeper into her, surprised by the way he was opening up to take all of my cock.

“Would you let Ethan fuck your mouth like this?” I growled.

To answer, Natalie lifted her eyes and met my stare. My cock was plunging in and out of her face, and the image was so filthy and raw that I could barely believe my dirty mind went even *further*, to imagining that this was Ethan's cock in her mouth instead of mine.

I felt myself rising up the point of no return, and I pulled out of her mouth, pulling her hair back at the same time, to make sure I didn't go over the edge. Not yet.

A long trail of saliva stretched between my cock and her mouth. It grew heavy in the middle, dipped, and sank onto her skin, over her throat and the exposed area of her chest, sinking into the pink cotton fabric, dirty and wet. We were both panting, staring at each other. “What else would you let Ethan do to you?” I said.

Natalie slid her hands between her legs. It took me a moment to realize that she wanted me to follow her fingers with my eyes, and see what she was doing.

I scooted backwards on my knees, until I could look down and see her fingers pulling her pussy apart, playing with her clit. “I don't know,” she said. “What do you think a man like Ethan would want me to do?”

My cock flopped in the air, and I saw the devilish delight in Natalie's eyes when this happened. She was stroking her clit with the pointer finger of one hand, while she pulled the hood back with the other. I stared. She had never masturbated in front of me like this.

“Ethan,” I breathed, “Would do all kinds of very, very bad things to a sweet little girl like you.”

I almost dirty-talked myself into an orgasm. My mind filled up with images of Ethan and my wife. Natalie lying on the guest bed with her legs spread like she was right now, playing with her cunt, dipping her fingers into her pussy, getting herself nice and wet for Ethan's fat cock.

Ethan pounding his cum into her.

Ethan's dick spreading her mouth open wider than she had ever experienced, making her eyes water as she gagged on his immense meat.

My cock flailed wildly again.

I reached under her legs and turned her slightly sideways, pushing her legs up toward her head. Her underwear were still caught somewhere around her knees, and I was still encumbered by my pants. But it didn't matter. I slid my cock into her engorged hole. Her flesh was slippery with her excitement, her body hot. The pressure from her body, angled the way it was, rubbed on the left side of my cock more than the right, an almost too-pleasurable-to-bear caress as I fucked her. It was a strange enough sensation to offset my climax by a few minutes, long enough to make Natalie twist and writhe beneath me and then burst into wet spasms around my cock as she came.

I dropped her legs to her side and ground my cum into her with her face turned sideways and her eyes closed.

Imagining, I hoped, Ethan.

I collapsed on the bed, face-up, with Natalie turned toward me in the slightly fetal position she had been in as I hammered myself into her. She had a little smile on her face, though what was generating it, I didn't know. Was she just basking in the glow of her orgasm, or was she amused by our game, or was she actually thinking about the things I was thinking about? Like how it might be even more fun, even hotter, to take things to the next level, beyond fantasy?

I lifted a hand and pulled her hair away from her face. She came to life, opening her eyes and stretching her legs down, simultaneously arching toward me. Her skin was damp with sweat, her cheeks flushed. She brought her thumb to her mouth and bit on her fingernail. She opened her mouth to say something, but then seemed to think better of it.

"What?" I said, trying to make light of things in the event they were going to get heavy. I peppered the word with a generous sprinkle of fake laughter.

It was like being new lovers again. Awkward in the same way, and exciting in the same way. The itching sensation inside my heart was back, of not really knowing what Natalie thought or would do. It was a terrible feeling but it was also like a drug.

Natalie rolled onto her back, and looked up at the ceiling with an open-mouthed smile. "Nothing," she said. "I was just... so... nothing."

"Must be something," I pried. Excitement was building up inside of me again, now almost to the point of making me sick. She seemed so close

to saying something, something I desperately wanted to hear.

She turned on her side. "It's just..."

I waited. Even though I felt like I was being torn apart from the inside out, I had the good fucking sense to close my mouth and wait. I was breathing like a horse through my nose, but it seemed crucial to me to guide myself through this whole thing by repeating: *keep your mouth fucking shut, Erik.*

And then actually doing it.

Natalie lowered her eyes.

"Um, it's just... maybe this is a little bit dangerous, you know? Like... I mean, Ethan *is* living here."

Now, if I played a recording for you of Natalie's *voice* saying this, it would sound to you like Natalie had a real genuine problem with this whole thing. So contrite. A girlish voice, like she could hardly stand the filth of the idea behind the words she was saying coming out of her pristine English-rose pink mouth (that, I thought with great pleasure, I had just fucked).

But even while she put on this act with her voice, her body did quite a different thing. She lifted a hand and stroked my chest, and her mouth formed a wry little smile, and she kept her eyes on my chest but batted her long eyelashes. She twisted next to me in a feline stretch.

"Dangerous, how?" I breathed, and then repeated to myself that I needed to shut the fuck up.

This was a delicate situation. I felt the way I had felt when I had finally made about seventy circles around Natalie, back when we met, and finally seemed to be getting cleared for landing.

After all, I thought. You wouldn't actually want to know what a man like Ethan would do to you, Natalie. You wouldn't actually want to do those things: let Ethan seduce you, let Ethan bend you over the kitchen counter and pump you full of his seed...

Natalie's eyes fluttered up and she looked at me. I went cold for a second, because it almost seemed as though she had read my very dirty thoughts.

"I just mean that... you know. It seems to be a turn-on for you... and me... and... Ethan doesn't exactly seem like a, you know..."

My mouth opened. "Celibate guy?" I offered.

She laughed. She patted my chest affectionately. "Or, uh... the kind of guy who really cares about, I don't know... wedding vows." Her voice

dropped with her eyes. “Or anything like that.”

“So you think...?” I said, after the pause seemed to long.

She shrugged. Whatever it was, I thought (with no small amount of glee), she didn't want to say it.

I took her hand. “How do *you* feel about that?” I said.

Genius. Sometimes I hear myself saying things and it re-occurs to me how it came to pass that someone let me into law school. Thinking on my feet, that's how.

Natalie turned back onto her back, putting her hand on her forehead theatrically. “Ohhh!” she said. She flipped back toward me. “I don't know. I don't know... it's...”

I kissed her hand again.

It was time.

My skin was practically flaking off of me with the excitement I felt. My cock was hard again. I'd let her know about that in a second.

“Listen,” I said. “You remember when I talked to you about... you know, how I had this fantasy?”

She looked a little confused, and scared, so I plowed ahead.

“And you thought it was just a fantasy, you know, like role-playing?”

Her face didn't change much, but her eyes dilated, and it was like I had shot her full of something. Interest – extreme interest – was apparent in her pupils.

Going in.

My heart was kicking at the walls of my chest.

Try not to die of a heart attack, Erik.

“I let you think, at the time, it was just fantasy, because... well, that's what you thought. But... I think that if you have, you know, *interest* in the idea...”

Her eyes were wide and almost black. Her chest rose and fell rapidly against my arms. I moved closer to her, so she could feel how much this excited me, too. The air between us was damp and hot, and I could smell that her excitement had turned to honey again between her legs. “Maybe we could just see what happens if I leave you at home with Ethan, hmm?”

My cock flexed just saying the words. The corners of Natalie's mouth flickered, letting me know she felt it, recognized what it was that had made me twitch. She squirmed a little and lifted her legs.

I slid my hand down to my cock, and Natalie opened her legs by lifting her outside leg and sliding it between mine. I guided the head of my cock to her wet folds, and her clit was so engorged that it was easy to feel, darting in the slippery, wet material of her lips. I pressed against her. “So would you say that's 'interest?’” I asked. “Are you interested in seeing what Ethan decides to do with you when you're alone in the house?”

Natalie's eyes were wide, and her muscles were stiff as she neared another orgasm. She didn't answer me, she just stared into my eyes until I made her come. She closed her eyes as she shuddered with her own climax, and I grabbed her by the ass and pulled her into me, sheathing my dick in her soaked and spasming pussy.

It didn't take long for me to come, again, especially with all of the dirty thoughts that had rained inside my head right after I thought about “dirty things” and my wife “alone in the house.”

With Ethan.

All month long.

CHAPTER 5: HOME ALONE

“What happened to your other jeans?” I said, watching Natalie slide a pair of conservative-length sporty shorts over her black panties and shake herself into them.

She weaved her hands into the sleeves of a short-sleeved shirt and gave me a quizzical look. “From yesterday?” she said. Her voice was slightly muffled by the shirt as she pulled it over her head. “I wore those... yesterday.”

“They were hot.”

She looked at me, then looked down at her shorts. “These aren't?”

The shorts she was wearing were cute, but in a sort of, “I'm a cute soccer-mom” kind of a way. The cutoffs had been sexy. I wanted something a little dirty, a little surefire, something that not only tempted Ethan to act but to act quickly and uncontrollably. Something that advertised that Natalie was a really dirty girl.

Even if she wasn't.

But maybe she could be.

My cock was getting hard just savoring the possibilities.

“The jean shorts were *really hot*.” I said.

“Really?”

I narrowed my eyes. “As if you didn't know that,” I said.

Natalie smiled. “I wore them yesterday, though.” She whispered at me. “I don't want to look desperate.”

This was a good point. In fact, it was a really excellent point.

“Excellent point,” I said.

After all, this was going to be so much more fun if *Ethan* went after *her*, and not the other way around. I appraised the shorts again. They were actually very hot, just not very short. There was no denying that Natalie's pretty legs still looked great in them. “Turn around?” I said.

She gave me a twirl. Her butt did look very nice in the stretchy fabric. “Oh,” I said. “That's different. You look... great in those.”

Natalie smiled, and then she hugged herself. “Is this crazy?” she said.

“Wearing yoga pant-things when you could be wearing cutoffs?” I asked.

“Idiot,” she remarked, but she was smiling. She actually looked behind her before she whispered again. “I *mean* Ethan. I mean, what are the rules? How far do you want to go with this?”

A very, very filthy image flashed through my head. *Honestly, Natalie, you don't want to know.*

“Look,” I said, and I felt the familiar quickening that happened below the surface of my skin when I was about to lie. It didn't affect me, really, and I was a lawyer so it wasn't the first time I'd felt it by a long shot. “Nothing's happened yet. It's possible nothing will. Let's just... see. Okay? Just have fun with it.”

This wasn't *really* a lie, anyway. Except the part about it being possible that nothing would happen. Because I could tell that Natalie was all for making it happen, and I knew Ethan wasn't the type to put the brakes on – on himself or anyone else.

I got onto my knees and walked to the edge of the bed, beckoning Natalie with my hand. When she reached me I pulled on the zipper of her top. The soft curve of her creamy breasts burst into view. “There,” I said. I moved one hand to her rear, and pulled her close to me so I could kiss her.

She seemed a little uncertain, now, of what she wanted to do.

“Look,” I said. “You don't have to do anything. If Ethan's hitting on you and you don't like it, don't flirt back. We'll throw him outta the house. All this is saying is... if Ethan flirts with you and you... you know... want to respond, then... it's okay with me.”

Natalie looked at me. Her face was twisted up in a confused frown.

“I just want you to tell me about it, whatever happens.”

Natalie sat down on the bed. “I don't know,” she said.

I sat back on my heels and stroked her arm. I kissed her shoulder. “What don't you know?”

She turned to me. “It's just... I guess I'm having a hard time, you know, trusting that this is okay. I feel like... maybe this is just your fantasy, and if it gets real, you're going to see it and it won't be good at all and then there's going to be a thing between us.”

I kissed her shoulder again.

She had a point, and a better man might have let himself be a little less led around by his cock. But this was a fantasy I had kept bottled up for so long, with no hope of it getting let out, and this opportunity seemed like

it was going to be the only real chance we ever got. So instead of thinking things through as much as they probably warranted, I did a lawyer-thing.

I made it sound like I was conceding her point, while still marching ahead with what I wanted anyway.

“You're right,” I said. “We need to think about this. But I promise you, as far as I'm concerned, this is what I really want. I won't have any regrets.”

I paused, just the right amount of time. So much of talking people into things is in the perfect mix of silence and sound. “How about this? Let's just play it by ear. See what happens with Ethan. Just react... however you feel.”

I knew that Natalie was enticed by the idea of doing something with Ethan. I could see it in her flushed face, her quick breath.

I stroked her arm again. “If it doesn't work out, it doesn't work out... just let it happen however it feels right to you. Okay?”

Natalie nodded. She looked at herself in the mirror. I really wanted to see if this conversation had gotten her as worked up as it had me, and I felt pretty sure that it had. But I resisted the urge, because this was a delicate moment, the moment to convince her to finally go through with what I wanted.

I waited. She gave herself one last look in the mirror, and went out the door.

Ethan, to everyone's surprise, was up and making pancakes, bacon, and eggs when we came out of the bedroom.

He flipped a pancake with grace, caught it in the frying pan, and smiled warmly at us. First at Natalie – a special, very charming smile; and then at me. “I,” he said loudly, “have prepared an authentic Southern breakfast for you, my lady, so you can paint all day and take the art world by storm.”

“There's nothing authentically Southern about this breakfast,” I said, kissing Natalie on the cheek as I squeezed past the stool was sitting in so I could get to the fridge.

“Has it been cooked by an authentic Southern gentleman?” Ethan asked the four corners of the kitchen. “Then it is an authentic Southern meal.”

“It's been cooked by an authentic Southern asshole,” I quipped.

Natalie was looking from one to other of us and obviously having a thoroughly enjoyable morning sitting on her barstool and being entertained while someone else did the cooking. She was smiling for both of us.

“Even more authentic,” Ethan said dryly.

But he wasn't looking at me, he was looking at Natalie.

And he winked.

I took a fresh juice shake out of the fridge and shook it. I surveyed the scene in front of me, and decided it was very much proceeding according to plan. When Ethan turned his back I raised my eyebrows and looked at Natalie. She raised hers back.

“I gotta run,” I said.

Ethan held up a hand. “I'll take good care of your wife for you, buddy.”

Natalie didn't look over at me, she just leaned into the counter and bit on one of her fingers.

But the smile that moved underneath her mouth was for me.

CHAPTER 6: ACCORDING TO PLAN

The kind of work I do as an attorney doesn't require a ton of brains. I don't even really know how I ended up here. I was a pretty good performer in trials, back when I worked in Colombia after I got out of school. I do well in small claims court.

I just didn't see the point of working so hard when you can make pretty much the same kind of money just filing papers and getting home by 5pm.

One thing that my work does require, however, is paying attention to fucking detail.

And there was none of that going on.

I wondered how long Ethan would wait before he swept in hard and fast on Natalie. He was flirting with her right under my nose, and while he did a good job of creating a plausible “joke” out of it, his intentions were clear, as they always were with Ethan.

And I wondered what Natalie would do. I'd given her license to do what she wanted. How would she play it? How did she feel about Ethan, to begin with? Was she actually be attracted to him, or was she just appeasing me by playing my game? Would Ethan charm her into a real attraction? Would they just watch me drive down the road and then tear each other's clothes off and fuck on the kitchen floor with all the drapes open and the neighbors watching?

My thoughts went from psychological to physical imaginings in a hurry. They could be kissing right now, Ethan pushing Natalie up against a wall, his hand sliding down her shirt, finding her nipple and squeezing it....

At ten o'clock I texted Natalie.

[Me]: *So. How's it going?*

There was no reply.

I tapped the phone nervously and read through a will without seeing what was on the paper. I started over, and my thoughts wandered again.

It wasn't unusual that Natalie hadn't answered. She wasn't one to carry her phone with her everywhere.

But was she not answering because she was busy with something else?

I had a brief flash of panic. I had actually just given my wife permission to flirt with a predator, and what's more I had basically told her to do whatever she wanted.

She could be *fucking* another man right now.

It seemed so real, when I thought about it like that.

“Shit,” I said aloud.

My whole life is one long story of things like this, so don't go thinking I'd lost my whole mind over this. I was always trying to get the ball rolling, jump in, get things started, and then having my second thoughts about twelve hours later.

But there was no answer from Natalie all day.

I put myself to work doing the easiest jobs possible, jobs that were really for Sandy, who was out for two days doing some kind of Civil War re-enactment or maybe paintball...unimportant. It was all I could concentrate on. When I ran out of paralegal work, I set to looking through my own files and found that I was staring at them blankly. My thoughts were all paranoia and fantasy.

I gave up, and headed home.

I wasn't actually expecting much to be afoot when I got home. I was actually impatient to get things moving faster. I envisioned ways of throwing gasoline on the fire as I drove through the easy-going late afternoon streets.

Little did I know how silly that was.

There was no answer when I called out Natalie's name as I walked through the door to the garage and into the kitchen.

The door to the back porch was open, and I pressed my face up to the screen. “Nat? Ethan?” I squinted to see into the yard, out to the shed, hoping to catch a glimpse of Natalie bending over provocatively while Ethan looked on.

But no one was in the yard.

I spiraled out of control with my thoughts pretty quickly. I looked around the kitchen and held my breath to be able to hear the rest of the house better. Trying to hear the sounds of two people fumbling around for

their clothes on the floor, or trying to grind into each other as quietly and as quickly as possible before the husband comes through the door. What would Natalie do, if she was about to get “caught?” And what kind of slut had Natalie been, to fuck Ethan so early in the game? Were they in a room of the house right now, unable to hold back their needs?

I heard nothing.

I crept down the hallway on the main floor. By then I had half-convinced myself that they were, really, behind the closed door of the guest room (where Ethan was staying), writhing on the sheets. I put my hand on the knob and turned it slowly, making no noise, in the event that I could get a glimpse of their bodies wrapped together or Natalie's legs spread wide and Ethan's bare ass bobbing between them.

But there was no sound through the door, and no sound when I opened it a crack wider. I pushed it open fully with my fingertips and stared at the bed.

It was unmade, and that gave me a little flicker of hope. It died out quickly, though: the bed was unmade but looked like a single person had slept in it. The covers were thrown back for one person, not two fucking lovers.

I went through all the other bedrooms, excitement building at each door, disappointment and relief sliding over me when I found each room empty.

I had almost forgotten the *real* mystery. Where the hell were they, if they weren't here?

I texted Natalie from the kitchen, and her phone rattled on the counter no more than half an inch from my pinkie finger.

I went outside. I felt claustrophobic all of the sudden. I was letting way too many awful thoughts surface in my mind: thoughts of betrayal, absurd thoughts about Ethan having seduced my wife in a mere afternoon, and having convinced her to run away with him.

I leaned on the railing and tried to calm myself.

Then I heard Natalie's laughter. It clattered in my right ear, and for a moment I had an awful thought: they were in my bedroom, on the floor, and I just hadn't seen them. I spun around to go inside, and that's when she caught my eye.

Natalie. A tight white t-shirt clung to her body. She still had the workout shorts on, but the shirt made me narrow my eyes in suspicion

before I even took in the rest of the scene.

And then my blood boiled. She was walking next to Ethan, but she was walking *so close* to him. She was leaning into his arm with her whole body. Their outer arms were pressed against each other, and they were walking as though they were two drunks holding each other up.

They looked like a couple.

A very well-matched pair.

They also, I noted with a stab of pain, looked like they had known each other a long time. Natalie was laughing again, and it almost looked as though she had placed her head on Ethan's chest.

They were holding something in their hands.

This hadn't taken very long, I thought, and even though it was what I had believed I wanted, the fact that it had taken less than 24 hours for Ethan to get my wife snuggling up to him was *too much*.

And Natalie. What a fucking act she had put on this morning, when in reality she couldn't *wait* to get Ethan to “seduce” her. And with my permission no less.

And why was she wearing that white t-shirt? It was one she professed to hate, and one I loved, because it was made of very thin material and her skin showed through it in a very sexy way.

I felt like my blood pressure had probably doubled.

The two kept walking toward the house, oblivious to everything except -

Except.

Well, they weren't necessarily pressed together as I had thought at first sight. They were sharing a phone, and walking very close to each other.

They were also eating ice cream.

I closed my eyes for a second, picturing Natalie placing her lips on a big scoop of ice cream and sucking it up into her mouth, or placing the blade of her tongue on it the way she had lapped at my cock. And Ethan, sitting there watching her, thinking about how he could get his cock right where that ice cream was -

“Oh! Hey honey!”

I opened my eyes.

The two of them were a couple of inches away from each other now. And as they walked toward me, saying, “Oh hey buddy,” and “You're home early,” they seemed to get further apart.

I felt more fingers of painful jealousy working through me. It was a sign of guilt, guilt at standing so close together, which could only mean one thing: there was some inappropriate behavior there.

Natalie smiled at me and twisted her ice cream under her tongue, staring straight at me as she did. “We would have waited for you if we had known you would be back early.”

She winked at me.

This was a reminder that we were playing a game here, and I was the one who had suggested it.

I looked at Ethan. He flipped his phone around so I could see the screen. “Check out these dogs,” he said.

I looked at the screen. Innocuously enough, a large Great Dane took up most of the picture, and seated on its head was a Chihuahua. It was Reddit-worthy pointless cuteness, and in the background were the obnoxious teal and hot ink stripes of Clancy's Ice Cream. The place down the street.

It was now the turn of disappointment to roll over me. They had just been laughing at the dogs. They had only been walking close together to look at their sixteen-photo series of the Chihuahua sliding off the Great Dane's head and the big dog catching him by the scruff.

I looked at Natalie.

I reached for her torso and brought her close to me. Her skin – a little tan for some reason I still hadn't figured out – showed through the thin material of her shirt.

As well as the pale blue of her bikini.

I kissed the sliver of her skin between the shorts and the shirt. I inhaled at the same time, hoping to get a whiff of a scent that came from Ethan, but instead got a faint whiff of chlorine. “Did you go for a swim?” I asked, and the question was originally meant for Natalie, but I looked at Ethan while I asked.

“Gotta get a suit,” he said.

It still begged the question: had he gone to the pool and watched Natalie swim? Or sunbathe, as she seemed to be doing much more of than she ordinarily did.

Ethan looked at Natalie, and they seemed to exchange a look between themselves. A look like: “Oh, wasn't the pool so much fun?”

I imagined Ethan lounging on a chair, watching Natalie's ass and her long legs as she slinked around the edge of the water to the deep end, stretched her arms over her head, and knifed it into the pool. Then watching her walk back to the chair next to him, slicking her hair back, every long, exposed inch of her dripping wet.

I felt my cock twitch with envy and lust.

But just like that, the look between them was gone, and I was never really given an answer as to whether Ethan went to the pool with her or not.

Natalie suggested hamburgers. I ended up on grill duty while the two of them reclined in Muskoka chairs we had brought back from a trip to upstate New York. Natalie stretched her legs out across another chair, right in front of Ethan's eyes. She was really laying it on thick.

I stared at her legs over the warped hot air of the barbecue and watched her shake her hair loose. She twirled a lock of it in her fingers. She was staring at Ethan while he went through his usual repertoire of lady-killing jokes and compliments.

I knew that I had asked Natalie to do this, and to be honest, it was turning me the fuck on. But there was an unexpected edge to it, something unsettling. Did she have to be so *into* it, so good at it? She hadn't flirted with a man in thirteen years (at least I hoped). How was she picking it up so easily? And why was she so happy to throw herself into the job? Had she been craving this kind of attention, maybe, and was now relieved to finally have permission to seek it?

And fucking Ethan. What a guy. Of course I had no reason to be angry. I knew what Ethan was like, I knew he'd chase any skirt in the world and that he just didn't see things the same way other men did. He wouldn't view another man's wife as out-of-bounds.

I had invited him here specifically *because* he was like that, after all.

Still. What a fucking piece of work, moving in on another man's wife like that right under his nose.

I flipped a burger, and the sizzle of the meat snapped me out of my reverie.

I looked back up at the two of them.

On the other hand, they could just be two people stretching out on lawn chairs on a hot summer day, having a good conversation.

I squinted through the wavy air.

It was possible I was just getting ahead of myself, letting my fantasy-nightmare alter my perceptions.

The moment I had that thought, though, Natalie brought one foot to the shin on her opposite leg. She used her pretty toes – which I noted, she had painted a coral-pink – to scratch an itch on the front of her leg. It was a very deliberate action, and very unnecessary. It was designed to do exactly what it did: it spread her legs open a little, probably revealing whatever she was wearing or not wearing under her jean shorts. And it drew Ethan's eyes directly to the center of her legs, where they lingered for just a moment too long. When he looked away, he had to jerk his eyes from what he had seen.

The interest in his eyes was *very* apparent.

Just then Natalie looked over at me. She had a mildly triumphant look on her face. She lifted a bottle of beer to her mouth and took a sip of it, letting her lips linger for along time on the edge of the bottleneck, conjuring all kinds of filthy ideas for me (and I hoped, for Ethan). Then she stood up and came over to the barbecue.

She slid her hands around my waist, stood up on her tip-toes, and kissed me on the neck. “How long 'til those burgers are done, honey?”

“You're certainly laying it on thick,” I said, in a low voice. Ethan had gone over to inspect something by the shed and was too far away to hear us now.

Natalie purred in my ear. “Do you know the best part?” she said.

I didn't answer, just sort of flinched as she moved her hands from my waist down to my cock, where she ran her fingers over my erection. So much for pretending I didn't like it.

Her mouth was very close to my ear now. “When I got back from the pool, I didn't want my bikini bottoms to get my jeans all wet,” she said. “And I couldn't find any clean underwear...so...”

She gave me a final squeeze, and as she did she surely recognized that my cock had gone to rock-solid with her words. She trotted back to her chair, and then, pretending that there was something on the ground, she bent over. The jean shorts rose up, up, all the way to reveal her bare bottom. While I couldn't see all the way to her snatch, just the idea that it was there, exposed, with nothing between her and her jeans, sent a shudder through me.

I had to wonder if Ethan knew that.

Another chill went through me. Maybe when he had looked into her jeans just moments ago he had seen for himself that she was going commando.

Natalie stretched out on the chairs again, and Ethan came back like a loyal puppy to steal glances at her crotch. She drew her fingers up and down the neck of her bottle of beer, feigning absent-mindedness.

It was almost too much for me to watch.

I stood there, staring at the two of them. Their mouths moved, forming words for one conversation, but Natalie's fingers and legs and Ethan's eyes were having a completely different conversation at the same time.

They were unmistakably interested in each other, and unmistakably trying to show it to the other.

And hiding it very, very poorly.

I smelled the unpleasant odor of char.

“Shit!” I said.

The burgers were burning.

“Need some help, buddy?” Ethan called.

The spell was broken. Ethan came over with a plate, and we sat down to have burgers, and both Natalie and Ethan went to great lengths to tell me they were not that burnt, and not to look at each other all through dinner.

“So?” I whispered, when the door to our bedroom was finally closed later that night. I wasn't interested in small talk. I was interested in extracting every possible detail of the day from her.

Natalie pressed her body against the door and smiled at me, biting her lip. She shrugged.

Her eyes were a little frightening, a bit like a buzzard's, at that moment. She was enjoying my pain immensely. Enjoying teasing me.

But then she seemed to take pity on me, and her eyes softened. She stepped forward and reached for my tie, which I had, almost hilariously, still not taken off. She played with it as she spoke. “Well,” she said. “The morning started out slow.” She smoothed the tie down my stomach, and her hand kept going, down to my pants and over my burgeoning erection. Then back up. The feel of my hard cock made her eye twitch a little in delight, but other than that she kept a sort of strange poker-face. She let me simmer with the idea of her “slow morning.”

“I asked Ethan if he would work on the shed, and he said, 'sure thing, pretty lady,’”

She did a very good imitation of Ethan.

“And then... he went out there, and I went to my studio.”

My mouth was open, and I was breathing pretty heavily. I felt like a rabid dog, almost.

Natalie watched me for a while, and then she smiled again, a little more comically. She patted my tie. “That's all.”

There must have been a look of crushed disappointment on my face. “And?”

She shrugged. “Look, I have to be honest, I think maybe Ethan just... isn't that kind of guy anymore. You know?”

I looked at her. “How'd you end up in your swimsuit? You didn't go to the pool.”

She looked down at her body, as if it surprised her that she was wearing it. “Oh. That. It was hot.”

I cocked an eyebrow.

“I was painting in it.”

“You didn't want to turn on the AC?”

I wasn't sure what was in my voice; I sounded almost accusatory. As soon as I said it, I felt like a dick, and Natalie folded her arms over her chest, equally annoyed by the embedded insinuation. It was, after all, ridiculous to chastise her for wearing a bikini around when I'd asked her to experiment with my fantasy.

I shook my head. “I'm sorry, I shouldn't have said -”

“See, this is the thing I'm worried about, Erik.”

“I'm sorry. I can't... it's just an instinctive thing.”

“Well,” she said, flouncing past me and sitting down on the bed. “It may not even matter, he doesn't seem to be taking the bait.”

I turned to look at her. She had her arms folded over her chest again.

“That... are you disappointed?” I said. And then, branching off on a different thought, I added: “That doesn't seem like Ethan.”

Could it be? I knew I should be sort of happy that Ethan was respecting my marriage enough not to actually hit on my wife, but I had gotten my hopes up so high that he *wouldn't*.

Respect my marriage, that is.

She looked up at me quickly. Then she shrugged. "I guess it's for the best," she said.

A shiver went through me as I realized that she sounded... disappointed.

I sat down next to her. "It *is* only the first day you guys are here alone," I said, and I put my hand on her knee. "What if... what if you sort of stepped it up a little? I mean, a bikini is nice, but maybe you have to be a little more... forward, you know?"

Natalie looked at me, and her look was almost venomous. Then she put her hand in her face and started laughing. "I can't believe we're having this conversation." Her cheeks flushed again.

I moved my hand up her thigh.

Beyond the door, we heard Ethan moving around. He was a bit of a night owl. It sounded like he was planning to go out again.

"I have an idea," I said. "What if... you went out there in your underwear or something. And just... you know, ran into him? Maybe when he comes back from the bar?"

Ethan had advised us shortly after dinner that he was going out. He'd invited us, and we'd declined.

Natalie's mouth dropped, and she laughed at me again. "How am I going to know when he comes back from the bar? Set an alarm? No way," she shook her head.

But I could see the idea was getting to her. I could see that she was sort of picturing it.

"If you wore that shirt out, with no bra on... and maybe your little pink boy shorts? Then, look, if he's totally resistant to that we know he's reformed, right? And that's that."

We were whispering, like we were planning a train robbery or something. Natalie slid her fingers along her scalp and into her hair, and then pulled her head back, holding onto one of her silky locks. "You're kidding," she said, but she was smiling. She was making a face like she was aghast, but she really wasn't. I could see it in her face.

She wanted to try it.

"How am I going to know when to go out there?" she said. She was grinning.

I tapped my fingers on the bed. I shrugged. "I could go out with him," I said. "And text you on the way back."

We stared at each other. "This is fucking crazy," she said. "It's a Wednesday. You can't... go out every night with him. I'm *sure* I don't like *that* idea." She pressed her lips together. "This is getting too... silly. Look, I'll just try to listen for him tonight, and then... I'll try to be a little more... direct tomorrow."

"It'd be better to hit him when he's got a little less inhibition," I said.

Part of me couldn't actually believe that I was having this kind of conversation with my wife. The other part of me was strangely comfortable with it.

"You're evil." Natalie shook her head.

I moved my hand up her leg and leaned in to kiss her. "We could always... stay up a little later... do something to keep our minds busy while we wait..."

I was fully expecting for this idea to get turned down.

But Natalie grinned. "Okay."

If there's one thing that all of this had done for us, it was to add the spark back into our private love life, at least for now.

I woke up because it seemed like the power had gone out. The sudden silence of the appliances turning off was deafening. But I looked around, and everything was on. The alarm clock was flashing though, meaning there had been a surge of some kind.

It took me a moment to orient myself in time. I moved my hand over to Natalie's side of the bed. It was empty.

And cool.

I sat up.

Our plan hit me in the face, and I was instantly awake. Wide awake. My eyes adjusted to the light, my ears seemed to prickle, listening for any sound beyond the bedroom.

The door was closed. I stood up, scanning the shadows of the bathroom for any sign of Natalie. There were none. I crept across the plush carpet and stood next to the door.

Nothing.

I leaned my ear to the wood.

I knew it was going to be impossible to hear through the door, but I tried anyway.

Nothing.

My heart was beating furiously now. I put my hand on the doorknob and started to turn it.

What if they were right out there, or in the hallway?

I froze.

No. I would hear them, right?

Had Natalie really gone out there in nothing but her teeny-tiny pink pajama bottoms and her white t-shirt with no bra? To “run into” Ethan?

I had hoped she'd do it, but I hadn't really expected her to.

I pictured her gliding into the kitchen, her big pink nipples pressing against the fabric of the t-shirt. She had big aureole, light pink but starkly contrasted with her porcelain skin. Ethan would be able to see the full shape and coloring of her breasts through that shirt, even in the dim light. He'd know that her pajama bottoms served as underwear, that the only thing between his fingers and her pussy was the thin pink fabric.

I shuddered.

Then I kept turning and pulled the door open an inch.

There was definitely movement in the kitchen. The stove night-light was on, but the faint shadows cast on the living room wall, which I could see through the entrance to the hallway, shifted with the movement of someone.

Maybe it was just Natalie. Maybe she just needed some tea, or an aspirin.

Then I heard the voices. Whispers.

Two people talking in whispers.

And not, I thought with a shiver of delight and horror, because they just really wanted me to get uninterrupted sleep.

They were whispering because they didn't want me to wake up.

What were they doing?

Unable to take it any longer, and imagining the most filthy things I could, I crept into the hallway and pressed myself up to the frame of the entrance.

Still, all I could get was the whispering.

I turned my whole body very slowly, and peered into the kitchen.

I could see Natalie's round bottom and part of her legs. The pink nightie was hiked up – it seemed to me – especially high. She was leaning on the counter, her whole body practically lying on top of it, and one foot

perched on her other calf. The wall between the kitchen and dining room blocked my view of her from the waist up, and I couldn't see Ethan at all.

I almost couldn't believe what I was doing, and the plan I was making in my mind, as I dropped to my knees and crawled over to the low wall with an arched open-window between the kitchen and the dining room. I was well into the shadows, and the dining room was one that hardly anyone used, so I wouldn't be seen if they went to bed or even went to the living room.

But I might be seen, if I did the thing I felt myself doing: I rose up to peek over the overhang and into the kitchen.

The scene was hardly *sexual*, but that almost made it worse. Natalie was, indeed, in her tight pink pajama bottoms, and her tight white see-through t-shirt. Her hair was down, and she had it off to one side. Her shirt had pulled down, tight over her breasts, and I could see her hardened nipples through the fabric, even from where I was.

Ethan was also leaning on the counter, and their hands were very close in the center of the table. There was a phone there, as if they had shared something on it, but no one was looking at it now. It seemed to have served as an excuse to put their heads close together, and remain there after seeing whatever they had looked at. Natalie was tapping her fingers very close to his. Not yet touching, but you could almost *feel* the desire for them to do so.

Natalie was shaking her head. They weren't really saying much anymore, and I couldn't hear what they did say. It went on like this for a torturous five minutes. I didn't know if i was relieved that it was nothing more than this, or disappointed.

But then Ethan spoke in a low murmur. "I know it isn't right to say that," I heard him say distinctly.

It felt like a hot knife was punched through my chest.

Natalie looked up, and gave her hair a little shake to get it from her face.

She was about to say something when Ethan reached out and slid his fingers down the neckline of her shirt, until he reached the bend in the v-shape. Natalie remained as she was, mesmerized. He hooked his finger on the "v" and pulled on the shirt. He pulled until it snapped back onto her skin.

Natalie stayed as she was for just moments too long. Then she stood up, pushing away from the counter. “I... uh...” she said.

She moved around the countertop, toward the kitchen doorway, and Ethan stepped into her path. “Hey, Natalie,” he said. He held a hand toward her. “I’m sorry. I didn’t... I wasn’t thinking. I’m just a mess. I just..”

There they were, just a foot away from each other. Ethan hardly looked repentant, if you looked at his body.

I silently urged Natalie to moved forward. Put her hand on his chest, or maybe let him take her up in his arms right there.

“I can’t do this,” she said.

It felt good to hear her say that, but it was also a squeeze – and not a good one – on my balls. So close. I wanted her to take it just a little bit further...

“Natalie, Natalie, Natalie,” he said. He moved a tiny bit closer to her.

Like every woman Ethan went after, my wife seemed to get sort of intoxicated by him. She closed her eyes, and her body swayed a little, as though she a losing her balance. “I can keep a secret, if you can,” he said.

What a *motherfucker*.

After all, I’d known that about him, it’s the whole reason I’d put him in my house with my wife, but seeing it play out like this you had to give credit for being a dick where credit was due.

Natalie’s eyes opened. She swayed a little in front of him. He lifted his hand and put it in her hair, on the side that was down, running his fingers through it. His fingertips rested on her shoulder, and then trailed down her arm.

Then *Ethan* sort of shook himself. “God,” he said. “You’re right.” He held his hand up to pinch the bridge of his nose and inhaled and exhaled sharply. “I’m... going to bed.”

And he did.

I watched Natalie. She kept her eyes on him, and she let out air that she had kept trapped in her lungs as soon as he left.

Oh Natalie, Natalie, Natalie.

The one thing that was not going to be a disappointment: I would be able to find out just exactly how much Ethan’s charms had worked on Natalie.

And there was this: I didn’t believe for a minute he really wanted to stop there. Ethan was in for the long game. He had walked away to keep her

hungry, make himself look good.

And judging by the way Natalie was still swaying, her hand to her chest and her mouth open? He was doing a good job.

I snuck in after Natalie. I didn't want to come out of the shadows and scare her half to death.

She was sitting on the bed, the light on, one long leg crossed over the other.

She didn't seem at all surprised when she saw me come in and close the door quietly behind me.

"And where have you been?" she said. She leaned back on her hands, thrusting her breasts forward. Her hard nipples poked through the fabric.

She really was spectacular-looking, especially in that just-barely covered getup.

She twisted her ankle in a circle. "How much did you see?" she said.

It suddenly occurred to me that Natalie had been very sneaky. Very sneaky indeed. Why hadn't she woken me up? Had she wanted to hide that she was out there with Ethan? Would she have told me about any of this if she had come back and found me asleep?

"Why didn't you wake me up?"

She shook her hair behind her. "I tried to," she said, with a smile.

I *was* a notoriously hard-to wake sleeper.

"How much did you see?" she said.

"Just the end," I whispered, and I walked toward her. She was being one sassy little girl, for someone who just flirted with another man. And now I wanted to know exactly how it had affected her.

I stood next to her and looked down at her. She looked up at me with the same surprisingly wicked grin.

"Scoot back on the bed," I said, and this elicited an even more excited grin from her. She obeyed me, crawling backwards on her elbows until her feet were at the edge of the bed. I reached down and yanked her pajamas off, and then I pushed her legs open.

The scent of her excitement confirmed what I had suspected, but I looked down to take it in with my eyes: her pussy was glistening with her juices. I reached down with my fingers and slid them between her folds, feeling the slick evidence of her arousal.

You little slut.

“It looks like Ethan's slick, Southern charm has had quite an effect on you,” I said. “Maybe you should have taken him up on his offer.”

Natalie looked at me. “Maybe,” she said softly, with a grin. “But I think it will be so much better if we all have to wait a little bit, don't you?”

I was sliding out of my boxers and pulling my shirt over my head.

When I got the shirt off, Natalie had moved to the edge of the bed again. She was seated now, and she reached for my cock. She held it with one hand and put the tip on her lips, rubbing my shaft over her wet mouth. Then she began to work on the glans, licking around it, trailing the tip of her tongue along the ridge, pressing her lips together to warm the whole of it in her mouth. She lifted her eyes to me. “I'm sorry I was such a bad, naughty wife,” she said.

My cock flopped so much it slapped against her face. She steadied it with her hand, but her face revealed her delight with the reaction that I had. She rubbed the tip of my cock over her lips. “I hope I can make it up to you,” she purred.

My mouth fell open.

“What can I do to show you how sorry I am?”

Jesus fuck.

I put my hands in her hair, and pushed her down the length of my shaft. She sucked on my cock, taking me all the way to the back of her throat until she gagged.

“Good girl,” I said. When she came up for a breath I lifted my shaft and stood on tiptoe to drop my balls on her lips, and she took the cue marvelously and dropped to her knees on the floor, opening her mouth to let me drop my sack into the open hole of her mouth. “Show me how you're going to suck on Ethan's balls. Show me what a dirty little slut you can be.”

My ball sack was hot and wet, and she strained to get it all inside of her. “That's it,” I said. “Open up.” She slobbered on my sack, sucking it for a few minutes, before she worked her way back up to my shaft and took me down her throat again.

“I want you to fuck me,” she said, panting as she held my cock and took a breath. “I'm so ready for your cock.”

“Get on your hands and knees,” I said. My cock was about to burst, and I hadn't appreciated the interruption, but I wanted to make her come and maybe scream so Ethan could hear it. I watched her climb onto the bed and tilt her ass for me. I rubbed my shaft over her wet cunt and up to her

ass. "That's just how I want you to do it for Ethan," I said. "Show me what else you can do. Show me how you can be a dirty little slut."

Natalie looked back at me. I could tell she was at a loss of what else to do, since she was a pretty straightforward girl with sex. I snatched one hand and slapped it onto her ass, and then I pushed her down to her chest and took the other hand. She let me move her like a puppet as I placed her hands on her ass.

"Pull your ass open," I said.

Natalie obeyed, spreading her cheeks wide and creating a picture-perfect view of her engorged cunt and the tiny pink eyelet of her asshole.

I wanted to go further, give her more and lewder instructions. Ideas so filthy I could hardly believe they came out of my own mind flashed through my head, but my cock was actually to the point of nearly exploding, and I didn't have time for them. I guided my cock to her dripping cunt and plunged inside of her.

She was so slick again that there was almost no friction. I slammed into her, and it took all of my willpower not to let my mind wander to how it would feel when I finally got what I wanted, and I pushed my cock into my wife only to find it sloshing with Ethan's cum and loose from being stretched by his thick, long cock.

I went over the edge, but Natalie was right there with me. She was still holding onto her ass, and I watched my cock pummel in and out of her, her hands submissively on her cheeks, as I filled her full of cum. She bit the duvet and yelled into it as her cunt welled up and overflowed with her own filthy orgasm.

Natalie was facing me, playing with my chest hairs and falling asleep.

After the buzz of coming wore off, I was back to my cyclical thoughts of distrust and lust, both wanting Natalie to go further and being furious that she had gone this far at all.

Of course, I knew I couldn't be a dick and say anything like that to her. There wasn't really any option, in my view, except to push it further. If I didn't, Ethan would take it further anyway, himself. I liked the idea of having control over what was happening.

I stroked Nat's cheek with the back of my hand and she stirred, but in the way that made it obvious she was drifting off to sleep and would rather be left alone.

“So you don't think Ethan's maybe for real, saying he doesn't want to do this?” I said.

A smile came to her lips, and she sort of snorted. It was a very dismissive, confident snort. She didn't need to say anything else: she thought the idea was preposterous.

It was a lot of confidence for Natalie. She had been a fairly confident girl when we met (not the type to laugh huskily at the suggestion that another man might *not* be trying to get into her pants, right under her husband's nose) but a lot of that confidence had faded with time, kids, age.

I looked down at her. Her oaky, shiny hair was spread out over the pillow, and her unlined face looked creamy with just a kiss of blush against my skin. Her lips were still pressed into a faint smile. Down by my chest, her pretty breasts moved with her breath.

Or maybe I was wrong? Maybe Natalie's confidence had been there all along, and she just never had a chance to use it? Maybe I hadn't been paying attention to my wife.

The realization loomed in my mind, pulsing with its truth:

Maybe I hadn't been paying attention to my wife.

I gathered her in my arms, and I hugged her. Then I kissed her on the head. Even I was not deaf to the contradictions of my physical actions and the next words that came out of my mouth:

“You sound pretty confident that you can seduce a man. That's... a new one.”

Natalie squirmed a little and opened her eyes. “What's that supposed to mean?” she said. She was a little miffed. It colored her cheeks when she got angry and it was impossible for her to hide.

I shrugged, and because I was holding her it moved her whole body as I did. She placed her hand on my chest to push herself away. “Just... you know. I'm surprised, is all. Not that you can do it, just that you... are so... seductive about it.”

Natalie pushed away from my chest to look at me with an expression that, really, I deserved. It's a look women reserve for when men make sexist fart jokes at someone's wedding, that kind of thing.

But then she gave her hair a little toss. “Huh,” she said. “So you didn't have any *confidence* in me? You thought maybe... what?”

I closed my mouth very deliberately. I was starting to get the feeling it was a good idea for me to shut up.

“Are you having second thoughts?” she said.

I shook my head and pressed my lips tightly together. If I just kept repeating to myself to keep my mouth closed then maybe I wouldn't say any more stupid shit.

“So you're just surprised? That I can seduce a man?”

I made a motion with my head that was neither “yes” nor “no,” and really, it was the most truthful thing I could have done. Natalie rolled her eyes. “What's that?”

“It isn't *that*,” I found myself saying. Honestly, *women*. A fucking cantaloupe could seduce a man, under the right circumstances, but this is a sentence I had learned the hard way to never ever, ever, let pass my lips again. “It's just that you're so... such a sex-bomb.”

This really could have landed in any number of ways with Natalie.

But... she smiled. Then she snuggled against my chest. Her fingers worked their way down to the curls of my pubic hair, which was still damp with her juices. My cock was getting hard again, and her mouth flickered with a smile when she confirmed it with her fingertips. Her breath was warm and moist on my skin when she said, in a low voice: “And what worries you about that?”

I turned and pushed her hands onto the pillow. My cock flexed against her leg, and she smiled again. “I guess I just didn't expect you to... like it so much. You didn't strike me as such a bad girl.”

“It's sort of fun,” she said, and my cock twitched again. She grinned. “You hardly seem to object.”

I was already on to other things. “Sort of fun, huh?” I was working my body around so that I could slide my cock inside of her without having to let go of her hands. “How's that? Is Ethan really working his magic on you?”

She dropped her eyes when she felt my cock twitch at my own words.

Then she looked back at me. “It's more like... It's really fun to be bad. It's like Ethan's a one-off, right, so I can be really...”

“Naughty?” I suggested.

She grinned.

I maneuvered the tip of my cock to the sopping opening of her cunt by putting my weight on her body. She struggled against me a little, which only made me want her more. My cock slid inside of her up to my balls. “And what kind of naughty things do you have in mind?” I said.

Natalie lifted her chin and squirmed underneath me. “You'll just have to wait and see.”

CHAPTER 7: NANNY-CAM

After we had sex again, I couldn't help myself. I had to pester Natalie again. When could she make it happen?

"I have a feeling that I can make it happen tomorrow, if that's what you want. But what's the rush?"

Natalie was amused with herself, I could see. She was pretty convinced that the rush had been created by her teasing me as we made love, and she was partially correct.

The other part of the rush, though, was that after the previous day, I didn't fully trust Ethan to be as big of a jerk as he used to be. I was actually starting to believe that he had a conscience, and he might move out of the house before my fantasies had a chance to be realized. The rush was that I was a little unhinged with my needs, and I wanted it *done*.

Also, who *was* this woman? She was negotiating this dark fantasy so... unhesitatingly, it almost didn't seem real.

"Oh.. okay," I said, and I was the one who was hesitant. "But... how are we going to arrange it so that I can..."

"Watch?" Natalie was right there with the word. She was smiling, too. She had a solution already. She held up a finger and disappeared out of the room.

"Hey good-lookin'" I heard Ethan say to her in the hall. Whatever Natalie's response was, it wasn't audible. I wondered if she had swung her hips to make the shirt crawl up and over her butt, giving Ethan a nice view as she walked away.

Or maybe the two of them were already in pretty deep. Maybe she blew him a kiss.

Anything was possible.

I listened. Ethan went into the bathroom and locked the door. The sounds in the hallway gave me no indication where Natalie had disappeared to.

An excited, nauseated feeling worked its way through me, as I let my imagination picture Natalie having gone into the bathroom with Ethan. I pictured him lifting her onto the counter, holding his finger to his lips to tell her to be quiet. Then his hands, sliding her panties down. I envisioned

Natalie rocking back and forth on the counter to help him pull the already sodden lace over her hips.

They wouldn't *do* that, of course. But the lack of sound in the hallway began to play tricks on me.

As the minutes ticked by, I pictured them fucking like rabbits on the counter, doing it quickly to not get caught, Ethan's hand over Natalie mouth to keep her from screaming because his huge cock made her come like a rocket. Their eyes locked in their mutual betrayal...

I stood up.

Natalie walked into the room at that moment. She had a teddy bear in her hands. She twisted it upside-down and right-side up in rapid succession.

I stared at her. What she was doing was so out-of-place, so far from the things I had just imagined, that it felt like I had fallen into another dimension.

"Nanny-cam," she said, annoyed that I didn't recognize the object. She sighed. "Let's see if it still works." She set the bear on the dresser and did something at the back of the animal, before plopping onto the bed and getting her phone. She fiddled with a few things and then smiled.

She flipped the screen toward me. "See?" she extended a leg to push me with her foot so that I went into the Nanny-cam's range of vision. I watched my legs and torso shuffle into view on her phone.

The picture was in black and white, and the resolution made it difficult to see details.

But it would certainly do.

I went over to the bear and turned it toward Natalie. Then I climbed over her, resting on her lower back. My cock throbbed against her back. I had positioned the camera well, and I could see myself crouched over her, her torso hidden and her long legs twisting out behind me.

It was a spectacular view.

I reached behind myself and slid my fingers along the length of her inner thigh, then up to her panties. It was hard to see the detail of what I was doing, but it was sufficient for my imagination – especially if I pretended the man I was watching wasn't even me. I found the hem of her panties and slipped a finger beneath it. I pulled it up and toward me, so that I could dip my fingers into her wet cunt.

Then I watched myself on the phone as I finger-fucked my wife. Her legs opened and then her feet twisted as I brought her closer to orgasm.

When I stopped, to tease her, just before she was about to come, her feet kicked and she tried to rise up beneath me to rub herself against my fingers.

“Spread your legs,” I whispered hoarsely. I took the phone from her, and I held it up so I could see her legs and the dark hole between them on the screen with more clarity.

Not ideal, I thought, as I watched my fingers slide between the folds of her cunt and over her clit. I watched her body jerk and spasm as I brought her to orgasm.

Not ideal... but it would do.

I had a moment in the car.

Everything was arranged. All I had to do was turn the key in the ignition and drive off to work. Then I just waited, and I relaxed, until my wife informed me that she was going to fuck my friend Ethan.

We had decided that the Nanny-cam looked pretty silly in our room, and I also wasn't too keen on them fucking the first time in our bed (or at all... but I wasn't overly resolute about this, either. There was some appeal to the idea of it).

Still, if she put the bear in the living room or the upstairs loft, on a bookshelf, it might not be so obvious.

I wasn't sure why I cared.

That was the thing: I felt certain that if I just told Ethan I wanted to watch him fuck my wife, he wouldn't even so much as flinch at the idea.

There was some other reason that I wanted to keep it secret.

Maybe it was something about finally pulling one over on Ethan. While he was there fucking my wife, thinking he was the one being a bad friend... I don't know, it felt *good* thinking about how *I* was actually the player.

But now that I was in the car, my keys in hand, and I had left Natalie in the house with Ethan with what was tantamount to instructions to try and fuck him in the upstairs loft, well... now I couldn't bring myself to turn the engine over.

What if *Natalie* were the ultimate trickster here?

Or what if Natalie *and* Ethan were plotting something themselves, together? A way of talking me into believing that I was at fault for getting them together? Maybe they had a relationship, outside of what I had seen so

far, and this was all a trick to make believe it was my idea. That I had somehow brought it onto myself.

I shook my head and wiped the sweat off my brow. It was still morning, and pretty cool, but I was sweating like a pig in the parked car.

These musings were absolutely moronic.

I wiped my face again and put the car in reverse.

But I had to think about it all the way to work, going through every turn of circumstance, reassuring myself that I had been in control of Natalie's "relationship" with Ethan all along.

The Nanny-cam was one of these inventions that you could leave on all day, supposing you wanted to watch your kid from work, and so we had done just that.

This meant that I, Erik Ossington, spent the whole day staring at my computer with the Nanny-cam feed on it, even though nothing was happening. Natalie had assured me she would text me when she felt the time was getting close, so there was really no need to obsessively check it.

Even so, I found myself staring at the black and white image of our upstairs loft, where Natalie had finally decided to leave the camera. The ugly couch that was a pull-out bed, in case we ever had so many guests at the same time that we couldn't fit them in the guest bedroom. The plaid of the couch, so at odds with all of the decor in the house, now seemed to taunt me on the black and white screen.

I stared at the screen, going through all of the interactions between Natalie and Ethan again in my mind, feeling alternate jolts of erotic lust and cold pain, for half an hour at a time.

What was Natalie doing, right at that moment? Had she really gone on a jog this morning, as she had been all dressed up to do? Or had that been that been just an excuse to wear a skimpy outfit?

No, she had probably really done it. She liked running, and she usually went a few times a week. She had probably come back dripping in sweat, her forehead sparkling with little beads of it, a dark stain in her sports bra where it had gathered between her breasts. Had she timed her return to "bump into" Ethan?

He would almost certainly take the bait. He would be able to smell her body, and imagine how she would look if they took a little tumble in the hay. It was a perfect plan, actually. If he saw her upper lip a little damp with

sweet, womanly sweat, her cheeks flushed with exertion, her hair springing loose from her pony tail and sticking to her skin, there was no way he'd be able to avoid thoughts of what she would look like if he fucked her. She would smile, lean over the counter while she drank some water, spill some down her throat, bend over so he could see her ass. Then she'd say coyly, "I just have to go take a quick shower," and his mind would follow her to the bathroom, imagining what she looked like as she ran the stream of water over her naked body.

I looked at my phone.

No text. No anything.

Jesus, Erik. It's 10:30.

Right.

Right.

She needed some time to get the ball rolling. I should be grateful for that. I should be glad that Natalie and Ethan didn't just jump on each other the minute I left the house; after all, that meant they didn't have some secret affair going on already. It meant that things were as Natalie said they were, and I still had some control over this whole thing.

I needed to relax. Trust my wife. Wait for a text.

I minimized the Nanny-cam screen and stared at a will. I had the intention of burying myself in boring but easy, rubber-stamp projects I'd been putting off.

At 10:37, after getting nothing accomplished, I maximized the window again and leaned toward the screen. I stared at the living room.

Nothing, not even the shadows outside the house, seemed to have changed.

Maybe it was frozen.

Maybe the Nanny-cam didn't work anymore.

Maybe.. and my heart took a plunge... maybe Natalie had known that, or somehow programmed it, and I was just staring at an endless feed while she went about her business, fucking Ethan all over the house.

I shook my head.

That was so ridiculous. It was a ridiculous, overwrought conspiracy.

Most ridiculous was the idea of Natalie programming a Nanny-cam. What did I even think that meant? If she really wanted to be evil she would just fuck him in some other room.

Was that what she was doing?

I looked at my phone, then back at the Nanny-cam. I must have done this thousands of times. When, when would Natalie text me? What were they doing at this moment? Was she even getting anywhere with him?

Maybe they had already done it. Maybe Ethan had been waiting in the kitchen when she got back from her jog, and helped her out of her sweaty clothes right then and there. Maybe he had already unwrapped my sticky, sweaty wife and licked all of the salty sweat from her body before he had plunged his prick into her sopping cunt. Right on the kitchen floor.

I wondered what kind of lover Ethan was. I wondered what kind of woman Natalie would be. Would she really get as dirty as she had hinted at getting? Would she decide that she wanted to make some of her own fantasies come true? And what were they?

On and on, until my stomach was so twisted in knots and my pulse was so high that I felt like I had the flu.

I put the phone away in a drawer repeatedly. I took it out and looked at it, again and again. It took all of my willpower not to text Natalie.

This was, after all, about trusting Natalie. Trusting Natalie to do what she thought was best, and trusting Natalie to tell me what was going on. I had to trust that there was a reason that Natalie wasn't communicating with me: maybe she was busy, maybe she was seducing him right now, and it just wasn't the right time to take out her phone and tell me she was working on it.

But she had to know that she was torturing me.

The minutes ticked by. I managed to get through a few files, but I set them on one side of my desk to be looked over again. I was so distracted I couldn't really trust myself to have done everything ultra-carefully.

The phone finally rumbled on the table. I resisted the urge to paw at it gracelessly like a crazed teenager. I picked it up calmly, my heart racing. It was my private phone, not the one I used for work, so there were very few people who could possibly send me a message other than Natalie, but I didn't want to get my hopes up too high...

[Natalie]: *ive talked him into a few beers. went to pool b4 i hink hes really into me*

I felt my stomach go cold. That was the perfect way to Ethan's heart, a few beers in the afternoon after prancing around in a bikini at the pool. I

could see now that Natalie was really playing the “cool-girl” act. I wondered how she knew just exactly how to press another man's buttons... or maybe it worked on any man, I don't know, but it was still a little disturbing that she was doing it so effortlessly. Having a few beers, laughing and going for ice cream, lounging around in the pool.

I wanted more details about that.

[Me]: *Did he go swimming this time?*

I imagined Natalie rolling her eyes, as she always did, at my impeccably written text messages. She believed that perfect spelling and grammar in a text made a person seem like a stuck-up asshole (but she conceded that it sort of jived with being a lawyer).

[Natalie]: *yep*

I had plenty of time to conjure several images in my mind, mostly of the two of them wet and slippery and entangled in the pool, to go through my head before her next text came through.

[Natalie]: *we wnt 2 mall 2 get new suits thats why took so long*

My heart felt like she had pushed a red-hot poker through it. Had they tried suits on for each other, then? Had Ethan spent the morning oggling my wife and telling her which swimsuit looked best on her? Had he enjoyed watching her tits jiggle in string bikinis that didn't hold her in, and following the curves of her plumped-up cleavage, stuffed into in retro binikis, with his eyes? Had he enjoyed the view of her ass as she slid a finger under the fabric to get the bikini to snap into place just-so on her bottom?

[Me]: *So you bought a new suit?*

There was a long, delicious pause.

[Natalie]: *hang on*

An even longer one, as I sat with the phone in my hands, panting like an animal. The silver device shook in my hands, and I stared at it, willing Natalie to write back, to not leave me hanging.

Finally, a photo.

Natalie had, indeed, purchased a new suit. It was a black bikini, and it her figure pushed it out nicely in all the right places. It was just a regular bikini *except* it had a few loose, criss-crossing black ropes hanging at her hips or between her breasts, giving it a vaguely slutty and BDSM-y appeal. She had snapped a photo of herself in the bathroom, and then typed:

[Natalie]: *gotta run now been here a long time txt u when its on*

And so all of my questions, like whether Ethan had chosen that suit himself, and whether she was wearing it outside to drink beer, would have to go unanswered for now. I would have to sit there and wonder what the two of them were doing, and what they had done in the pool, until Natalie wrote me.

The phone buzzed again.

[Natalie]: *I 4got to mentn things got pretty heated in th pool so looks good tell u all abt it later*

I set the phone down. How the hell was I supposed to work now?

I spun in my chair and stared out the window.

I had another wave of – I don't know what to call it. Not panic, just a sort of forceful reality – wash over me. Was I really doing this? Was my wife really doing this?

And once it was done, it wasn't the sort of thing that could ever be taken back.

What was I doing? What were we doing?

I picked up the phone. I think maybe at that moment I actually meant to stop her, or ask her if she really wanted to do this, just one more time, as a way of planting doubt until it blossomed into inaction..

But I didn't type anything, and I didn't call.

The truth was, even though it might very well be a terrible idea, I couldn't actually stop myself from wanting it to happen.

I looked back at the Nanny-cam. The room was still empty, and it still looked as though the image were frozen.

Was I crazy? What would happen after this? How was I going to feel, after I saw what I had wanted to see, and then I came home to my wife and the man who had fucked her? Would we all have dinner together as though nothing had happened?

A shiver went up my spine. I was such a deeply perverted man that the idea of Natalie and Ethan sitting at the table, making eyes at each other every time I turned my back, made my cock come to life with a thud.

Maybe Natalie would play footsie with him under the table, smiling at him wickedly when they thought I wasn't looking.

Except, of course, that Natalie knew that even if I wasn't looking, I knew what she was doing. It was a game to her, and maybe I found her willingness to play it as disturbing as the game itself. Or as delicious.

The minutes ticked by as though they were hours. Then they *did* turn into hours, and before long it was 2:30.

I had done almost nothing all day, I was starving, but I didn't want to go get food, out of fear of missing something on the Nanny-cam. I wanted to message Natalie, and I thought about doing it several times. In fact, I got part of a message typed out, and then I pictured Natalie in bed with Ethan, her bare body stretched out next to him, her hair disheveled and her ass sticky with his cum, holding the phone up so her could kiss her shoulder and read my desperate messages as he did. Though that level of betrayal seemed like a stretch, I still didn't send the text.

Finally, just when I thought I couldn't take any more, my phone buzzed.

[Natalie]: *noeeww*

I squinted. It took me a few moments to realize that she had typed "now." I yanked my eyes to my computer screen, where nothing was happening.

Oh god. It couldn't be *broken*, could it?

It seemed like eternities passed by. I was perched on the edge of the chair and holding my phone in one hand. My muscles were starting to ache from the way I was sitting, so tense, so wired, but I didn't feel it at the time.

I was holding my breath, and I only noticed this when at last a shadow moved on the screen, and I exhaled and then gulped in fresh air.

My blood pressure rose to the point that I felt deaf; the air itself was making a tinny, low whine.

There was Natalie.

She was wearing the black bikini, but over it she had on a bathing suit cover-up that really didn't deserve the name "cover-up" at all: it was little more than a few strings of crocheted rope dangling over her and tantalizing much more than it covered. Her body was still on full display, only now it peeked out between bits of knotted rope that hinted at... well, rope.

And then Ethan. He had on swimming trunks and a white shirt.

They hardly seemed to be in the throes of passion.

I felt like someone had poured cold water all over me. The disappointment sank into my skin.

Natalie went right to the bookshelf where the Nanny-cam was embedded. When she neared the shelf, her torso was right at the level of the camera. I had a nice view of her smooth stomach, the criss-crossing ropes of her cover-up dangling pleasantly over her navel and her elongated oval of a belly-button.

What the fuck was she doing?

Then she backed away. Ethan had plopped down on the couch.

I saw, then, that they each had a beer. They were moving in the loosely floppy way that people who are bit drunk move. Every movement was a little more exaggerated.

Natalie sat down on the couch next to Ethan.

She had something in her hands. Something she was showing him.

I looked at Ethan. He wasn't listening to her at all, as her mouth moved in some long story she seemed to be telling. He wasn't looking at what she was showing him, either. He was looking at her, at her mouth, but not like he wanted to hear what it was saying. At her hair, which his fingers were about to pick up and stroke. At her breasts, that I could tell he was thinking about squeezing.

"Clever girl," I said, in a low voice.

Clever, because Natalie was making it look like she was getting seduced. She was making it look like that so much that *I* could almost believe it, even though she had already told me what she was going to do, even though she had just texted me that she knew it was "on."

For a moment, I stared at my wife and found her almost terrifying. She was playing Ethan like a harp, and making it look like the opposite was happening. And she was doing it so... effortlessly.

I was holding breath again.

I inhaled, and I could hear my own breath inside my head, my ears were so blocked by the blood pumping through my body.

And then he made his move. He dropped his hand, which he had placed over the back of the couch, and let his fingers rest on her shoulder. Natalie's mouth paused, and then she continued speaking. Ethan moved his fingers so that the skimpy cover-up slid from her collarbone. He tugged it down and over her arm, exposing the swath of skin of her left shoulder.

Natalie turned to him. Her face was a mixture of surprise and mild indignation – a perfect expression that almost looked real.

So real that for a moment I felt the rage I might have felt if I was seeing this scene play out and it hadn't been planned.

Natalie moved her head slowly left to right, almost like she was telling him no, she couldn't do this.

What a thrill, watching her, knowing that she was telling Ethan “no” while she had every intention of saying “yes.” How long would she drag it on, letting him think he had to work on her? How hard would he try, if she kept on telling she couldn't possibly, because she was married?

What had happened in the pool, that had led them to here?

Ethan moved closer to Natalie. His mouth came within inches of hers. He was talking now, and I was sorry that our Nanny-cam didn't have audio. I would have loved to hear what he was saying. I also detested that it was black and white, and I couldn't see if his charming words were making Natalie blush or not.

I wondered what she was thinking right now, listening to him. Did she have herself completely under control, and was she reacting to him in carefully measured moves? Or was she letting herself actually get seduced, letting Ethan's charm get her wet, really dipping into the fantasy and imagining that she was actually doing something incredibly naughty right now?

Ethan stopped talking, and the two of them froze, staring at each other. For a moment I again believed that maybe the Nanny-cam was broken, and I would just have to stare at this final frozen frame that was captured just before my wife and Ethan fucked each other silly.

Then I saw Ethan's hand move, sliding along Natalie's collarbone and back to her neck, where he made little circles over the soft indent in her throat. Natalie's eyes dropped, and I saw her ribs expand with a sharp inhale. Ethan's lips began to move again. Whatever he was saying to her, he was saying it slowly, in a whisper, as his mouth moved closer and closer to Natalie's.

And then his lips were on hers.

I watched as Natalie let my buddy kiss her. At first, she was frozen and did nothing – she didn't even respond with her mouth. But then I saw the stiffness in her body melt away. She brought her hand up to Ethan's chest and pushed gently against him, but at the same time her own mouth moved as they kissed even more passionately.

And then it all seemed to happen very quickly. Moving together, they rolled out on the couch, Ethan on top of Natalie. His hands were now sliding along her ribs, under the cover-up, grasping for a handful of her breast.

Natalie had abandoned her act of needing to be convinced – or maybe Ethan's warm, dry lips had actually sent her over the edge, and now she was just giving in to her very real and uncontrollable passion. She clawed at his shirt, lifting it up and over his head. Her hands were moving over his torso, feeling his muscles, grabbing at whatever she could.

Ethan rose up to remove his shirt, and Natalie took advantage of the time to peel her cover-up away from her body and over her head. When she got it up and around her arms, Ethan fell down, putting a hand on the bunched material, trapping her arms above her head in the web of tangled crochet. He was leaning over her now, her legs between his, her arms caught above her head. She squirmed beneath him as he traced a leisurely finger from her mouth to her breasts. He moved his hand with a feathery touch over her chest, sweeping lower and lower until he hit the fabric of the bikini. Then his fingers pulled gently at the material, gave it a tug, and her breasts popped out from under the black fabric. Her hard nipples sprung loose into the air and she squirmed some more.

Natalie turned her head and looked in the direction of the camera. She smiled.

She was smiling for me.

Ethan was at work on her body. He lowered his head and sucked one of her nipples up and into his mouth. Natalie's back arched and her body

rose to meet his mouth. Her eyes closed, and the eye contact with me was gone. Her mouth fell open, and then she squeezed her eyes tightly as Ethan sucked her nipple. Maybe he even bit into it gently.

He moved to the other breast, and Natalie writhed under him as he subjected her to the same treatment.

After teasing her like this, he rose up on his knees, releasing her captive hands. Natalie brought her arms down in front of her, trying to pull them out of the cover-up. Ethan slid his swimsuit down, and his cock sprang out, hard and gigantic, pointing straight ahead of him.

I looked at my wife's profile as her eyes lowered to look at Ethan's cock.

Her hands, still tangled in the cover-up, reached for his member, and she held it with both of her hands, stroking the length of his thickness.

As she did this, Ethan reached behind himself, and used one hand to cleverly unbutton Natalie's jeans and slide his hand into her pants. When his jaw dropped a little, I knew that he had dipped his hand into her pussy and found how excited she was. He leaned his crotch forward so that Natalie could have a better grip on his dick, and he could dip his hand into her pussy further.

Now, he could have no doubt that my wife wanted him to fuck her.

He backed away and yanked her jeans and bikini bottom with him. Natalie kicked at the shorts, trying to get them off her feet, but they were still trapped around her ankles. Now she was bound at the wrists and ankles by her cover-up and her jeans, and Ethan was looming over her with his big cock dangling over her body.

He pushed her hands down, onto her stomach and between her legs and his. He crawled up the couch as she scooted down a little – the two of them moving in unison to get his cock right over her mouth.

I watched as my wife opened her mouth and ran her tongue along the underside of Ethan's shaft, from the base where she made a swirl over his dangling balls, all the way to the head. Her hands were still between her legs, squeezed tight by Ethan's thighs. He used one hand to rub his cock over her face, as she lapped at it greedily with her tongue, straining to get more of it. Whatever pretense of reluctant housewife she had been putting on was unraveling quickly; now she was just after his cock with her mouth, hungry to please him.

Ethan used his right hand to guide his cock into her mouth. He leaned forward as his shaft sunk in between her lips, puffing out her cheeks. He rested his hands on the edge of the couch and slowly moved his cock in and out of her mouth. I could see that the first slow thrust of his dick made her gag. He pulled out of her mouth to let her gasp for air, and glob of spittle fell onto her cheek. But she spread her lips wide for him again, and he began to slowly disappear inside of her throat until his balls bulged against her chin.

Ethan slowly face-fucked my very naughty wife like this for a few more excruciating minutes. I stared at the helpless position Natalie let herself remain in: her arms twisted in her cover-up between her legs, her only choice to open up and let Ethan fill her mouth with his cock.

He withdrew from her mouth and pushed her hair from her face, his fat prick just inches from her lips. I could see he was talking to her, and Natalie was lapping at his dick with her tongue. He edged back down to the end of the couch where her feet were, and at this point, Ethan himself disappeared from the view of the Nanny-cam.

Natalie's body slid across the couch – Ethan was pulling her, until all I could see was her upper body. She worked her hands free of her cover-up, and lifted her head to look at what Ethan was doing. Almost as quickly, she dropped back onto the couch and her back arched. Her eyes were closed and she began to toss her head back and forth.

It was obvious that Ethan had his tongue in the folds of her cunt, and he was driving her wild. She threw an arm up on the back of the couch and dug her nails into the leather until her knuckles went visibly white, even on the black and white of the camera. I could see what she was mouthing: “Oh god, oh god...”

No matter how much I wanted to believe that she was acting for my pleasure, it was clear that whatever Ethan was doing to her with his tongue had made her totally lose control of herself. I strained to see it, as though by staring hard enough at the edge of the screen I would see something more than the occasional, bouncing tuft of Ethan's hair.

Finally, Natalie's mouth opened wide and her body seemed to seize. She lifted her head and yelled, though I couldn't hear I felt it in my body, as Ethan made her come hard.

I was fumbling with my own pants now, not even thinking about where I was. I grasped my swollen cock, staring at my wife panting on the

couch.

Then Natalie twisted, and she rolled onto her stomach and crawled forward on the couch. Ethan's body came into view again. His cock appeared first, followed by his naked, muscular body walking on his knees toward Natalie. Natalie crawled until she was propped up on the edge of the couch.

Now my wife was bent over on her hands and knees, and Ethan was going to fuck her doggie-style. I sucked in breath, and my only thought was that I was grateful I would get to see his shaft as he plunged it into her cunt.

Ethan used one hand to move the head of his cock in leisurely circles between Natalie's legs. I couldn't see the details clearly, but by the way Natalie's mouth opened and closed in little gasps, I knew he was rubbing his shaft over her clit, getting her stirred up again. Natalie was always extremely tender after she came – this was something I remembered from long, long ago, when we used to have sex several times in a day. Her body jerked as Ethan stroked her; it was almost too much for her.

Ethan leaned forward a little and dropped his hand to her pussy. He began to stroke her, dragging her cum and juices up. It took me moment to realize that he was making passes over her asshole, swirling his fingertips over the pucker. A chill went through me. He wasn't going to actually try to fuck my wife in the ass on this first encounter?

But then I remembered a lot of things Ethan had said, and it occurred to me that this was just the sort of move Ethan would pull.

He put his hand back on his shaft, and moved toward Natalie.

But his cock slid in easily. He was disappearing into Natalie's pussy.

I stared as I watched his thick shaft disappear into her cunt, and then withdraw. He fucked her slowly, working her up into a froth. Natalie tipped her head back, her mouth open, as the thick shaft filled her up, teasing her slowly. She began to grind against him, but he put a hand down on her lower back to hold her still.

He wanted to take his time.

This went on for a while, as I almost boiled over the edge. I held cock in my hand but didn't move. I wanted to make it to the end, to see what he was going to do. I felt like I was going to be torn apart.

Ethan leaned over Natalie's ass, his cock still deep in her pussy. He pursed his lips and let a single, fat droplet of spit fall from his mouth. I didn't have a clear view of it but I imagined that it landed right in the center

of her pink eyelet. He shifted his hand slightly from her lower back to cup her right buttock in his hand.

Natalie's body froze all of a sudden. She stopped her gyrations toward Ethan and her head jerked up. Her mouth fell open and she began to breath quickly. I looked at Ethan: his hand was still on her ass, but it was sliding slowly inward. His mouth moved slowly, giving her instructions...

And then I realized. He was sliding his thumb into her ass.

Natalie's head dropped, and she began to arch her back upward. Ethan dropped his left hand from the couch and pressed gently on her lower back until she was arched like a cow again, her ass and head turned up. I stared as his hand went further and further toward the unseen center of her legs, where I knew his thumb was sinking into her ass.

For a moment they stopped, and Natalie squirmed, her mouth open, making some kind of noise I would have paid anything to hear. And then Ethan began to slowly fuck her again.

He let her get relaxed, just holding her ass with his thumb deep inside while he gently and slowly pulled his cock in and out of her pussy.

Natalie's stiff muscles began to melt, and she began to push back against him again. It was clear that she was enjoying what he was doing to her.

But almost as soon as her enjoyment started, Ethan slowed to a stop. Natalie wiggled and pushed against him. I could see that she was saying "please," and it nearly squeezed the cum right out of my cock. If I moved my hand, I knew, I would come right then. And it seemed that there was still more in store for the dirty little slut named Natalie.

Ethan turned his hand as he dropped another glob of spit onto Natalie's ass. I saw the muscles of the back of his hand move as he worked his pointer finger toward where his thumb was buried.

Natalie's mouth opened again, and I wondered if she was moaning or screaming as Ethan dipped his second finger into her ass.

He paused like this, as Natalie squirmed. He began to move his fingers, finally, and Natalie held herself still, apparently at his command, as he finger-fucked her asshole. His lips moved, and who knows what kind of dirty filth he was spewing, or what instructions he was giving her, but I could not believe that Natalie was letting herself be abused like this without even so much as flinching.

Ethan released his grip on her ass and switched his fingers, so that his pointer and middle finger were plunging into her ass. He began to finger-

fuck more rapidly, and she dropped her head again and then threw it back. Finally, she began to squirm, and then, unable to take it any more, she dropped her chest onto the couch and submitted completely.

I held my breath again, both horrified by the prospect of and cheering for Ethan to pull his cock from inside her pussy and fill her stretched ass with his even thicker cock. But he must have been quite ready to go himself, because he thrust into her and then began to pound her pussy with his fingers deep in her ass.

Natalie's eyes opened, and locked on the camera.

She smiled, as her cheek slid over the leather sofa with each hard thrust that Ethan pounded into her. She brought a finger to her mouth and bit it, and then her eyes rolled a little in her head as her body twitched again from head to toe with another orgasm.

Ethan pulled out just as his cum began to gush from the swollen tip of his fat cock. It sprayed out in thick ropes all over Natalie's back. He slid his fingers out of her ass and pointed his spurting cock at her hole, which must have been gaping, throbbing slowly closed on his sticky cum.

I finished myself off then with a few quick thrusts, and I clutched the desk as I came.

I hurriedly grabbed a pile of napkins next to my coffee from that morning, and had to squeeze my eyes closed to keep from yelling loudly. The walls were pretty thin in that building.

When I looked back up, Natalie had turned around, and was lying on her back. Ethan had crawled up to lie on top of her, leaning slightly on his side, his hand propped up on his elbow.

He stroked her chest, letting his hands wander all over her tits, lingering on her nipples. Then he leaned down and whispered something in her ear, and it made her laugh. He kissed her.

I fumed.

Shouldn't they at least seem awkward? He had just fucked my wife in such a dirty way, fucked his friend's wife, with his fingers in her ass, and he was just telling her jokes? And what about Natalie? Didn't she at least want to pretend she felt the slightest bit bad that the fingers she was bringing to her dirty whore mouth had a ring on one of them? A ring that represented her marriage?

You asked her to do this.

But still. I couldn't help the anger boiling up inside of me (and excitement, too, I admit) as the two of them giggled and kissed.

Finally, Ethan popped up and over the back of the couch. When he popped up from the floor, he was sliding his swim trunks on.

At that point, Natalie seemed to ask him something serious. The smile faded from his face, and he looked down at his feet. Then he looked back at her, and reached a hand over the couch to push a strand of her hair from her forehead. The gesture, though this may seem strange, was more obscene to me than anything he had done to her so far.

He said something (I can only imagine it was, “we just won't tell him,” or “let me figure out what to do,”) and the horror of my fantasy hit me in the face like a ton of bricks as Natalie smiled uncertainly.

Because now, they really *had* fucked each other, and all three of us had to do something. Either keep going, me pretending I didn't know, Ethan living in my house and probably fucking my wife again, and Natalie... Natalie what? Letting Ethan do even more dirty things to her?

And what if Natalie decided that Ethan was the better lover? What if Ethan actually charmed her so much that she forgot what she was doing?

I shuddered.

Natalie sat up, finally, and swung her legs around so that she was seated primly – although naked – on the couch. She looked behind her, and then she smiled at the Nanny-cam, and blew me a kiss.

She rose after a few minutes. Maybe they were minutes meant to make Ethan believe she was worried about what she had just done.

Or maybe minutes she pretended to think about things in order to fool me.

Then she disappeared

The Nanny-cam returned to its boring view of the loft living room. The leather sofa, the shelves full of books no one read.

But the image of Ethan, his cock deep in Natalie's throat, would never get out of my mind. It was superimposed there forever.

CHAPTER 8: AFTERMATH

My stomach was in so many knots on the way home that I had to stop on the side of the road and catch my breath. I was amped like I had downed forty coffees. I held my hands out in front of me, and stared at my hopelessly shaking appendages. There was no way I could go home like this. Natalie would be disappointed in me, and Ethan would surely see that something was wrong.

That's if Ethan was still there.

I pulled over again at a roadside bar, the kind of dive I would never had the ball to go into on any other day. It actually turned out to be full of sad middle-aged men like myself, and not bikers, as I had envisioned all the years I had driven by it without going in.

I had two drinks, and it calmed me down. It calmed me down in the sense that it dampened my physical shaking, but it did very little for my mental torment.

I had actually just witnessed my wife have sex with another man.
With Ethan.

And now I had to go home and pretend I didn't know that he had sucked her nipples into his mouth, that he had felt her ass squeeze his fingers while he pounded her soft cunt. The bartender topped off my second drink, giving me a look that said I seemed to be having a rough day. I caught a glimpse of myself in the dirty mirror behind the bottles, and I looked pretty rough. The edges of my eyes were red, like I hadn't slept or I'd held back tears.

I had no idea how to reconcile my feelings. On the one hand, when I thought about what had just happened, it hit me on the gut like the most terrible news does. The kind of thing you need time to process away, and until you have that time, it's too painful to even think about.

And even harder to think about was the dark truth that was inside of me: I was looking forward to it. I was looking forward to going home and watching Ethan pretend that he hadn't fucked my wife. I was looking forward to seeing the interactions between the two of them sizzle, looking forward to soaring and falling as I believed and then didn't believe in Natalie's loyalty to me.

It was pretty stupid, even with that low amount of alcohol, to drive. I did it anyway, not giving a fuck about getting disbarred after getting a DUI. The whiskey had gone down smooth and put just the right amount of steel into my nerves.

They were in the backyard when I got home.

There was a hammock stretched out between two trees, and Natalie was swinging in it. She had changed her clothes, I saw, and was wearing her blue bikini and old cutoffs now.

I took in a deep breath, and walked into the yard.

Natalie gave the hammock a little swing with her foot. "Check out this new hammock Ethan got for us," she said. She had a book on her chest. She smiled at me as though nothing unusual had gone on here at all.

She winked at me as Ethan came out of the shed. Her acting skills were terrifying. The ease with which she was playing Ethan (or playing me, or playing us both) was like discovering that there was an edge to the world all along, and that I had been inches from it all this time. Maybe everything was a lie, I thought bleakly.

Ethan was wiping his hands on a rag. "Hey bud," he said. "Got a sweet deal on that hammock." He nodded in the direction of the hammock, which was pressing a lovely pattern into Natalie's half-exposed ass.

"It's great," I said, and my voice was flat. Then I mustered a smile.

Ethan was looking at me strangely. Natalie looked at me and moved her head and her eyes. *Don't fuck this up*, she seemed to be saying.

I wiped my eyes. "Oh, it's been a long day." Then I clapped my hands together. "Well! Anyone for a barbecue?!"

Ethan looked from me to Natalie, and in that moment it almost seemed as if the whole thing was going to come out. My love of avoiding conflict made a pool of cold fear spread across my stomach. Waiting for Ethan's next words, I realized that I didn't want any of this coming out right now, not just yet.

Natalie jumped up. "*I suggest we make tacos. You grill up the meat,*" she said to me, her voice semi-severe, "*and I'll make the margaritas.*"

Natalie walked past me, and took my hand on the way into the kitchen. Ethan was looking around the yard, polishing something with his rag, as I turned to follow Natalie like a zombie.

"Yo okay?" she whispered, as she opened the freezer.

Was I okay?

I looked out the door at Ethan. Then back at my wife.

Natalie set a bag of ice on the counter. She placed a cold hand on my chest and looked at me. "Come on," she said. "Let's have fun."

Natalie seemed content to let evening drag out. She pranced around, being hospitable, but I couldn't help but think her constant questions about whether or not we had enough drinks or food weren't just an excuse for her to stand up and look tantalizing. To tease me, and to tease Ethan. She was enjoying herself immensely, being the center of two men's desires, being the center of a dark secret. Being a very naughty girl. She was terrifying in her confidence, but she was also irresistibly sexy.

Late in the evening, while Ethan was talking about his old job and Natalie was deliberately hanging on every word (she had no real interest in finance, I knew, but she was acting like she did), I had finally had enough. I stood up in the middle of Ethan's sentence, and without saying anything, I went around the table and hooked a finger under Natalie's bikini strap. I pulled it gently as I moved behind her, tugging her a little. I let my fingers linger on her shoulder. "Come on," I said. "Let's go to bed."

Ethan stopped talking mid-sentence. He sat there with his mouth hanging open a bit. Natalie fluttered her eyes at him and they exchanged a confused look. Was it because they shared a guilty act between themselves, and my unexpected behavior stirred guilt up in their belly? Did they think I suspected something about some shared complicity between them?

Or perhaps it was just that my departure was so abrupt, and I was taking Natalie with me so forcefully, that they gave each other the look.

I preferred to think it was guilt, though. I preferred to think that Natalie's simmering look at Ethan contained some truth in it, some element of having really been seduced.

As I watched Ethan, though, I began to understand that it was something more:

He was jealous. I could see it in his eyes. I trailed my hand down Natalie's arm as she stood up, and he watched me with well-covered animosity. Well-covered, but definitely present.

I pushed Natalie's hair away from her neck and kissed her.

"Uh... I guess we're going to bed, then," Natalie giggled.

I looked at Ethan. I was prepared to meet his eyes, if he looked at me. *That's right*, I wanted to tell him with my eyes, *she's chosen me*. Because Natalie could have said anything: "Oh you go to bed and I'll be in in a bit;" or "but we're having such a nice time." But she didn't. She chose to follow me into the bedroom.

The feeling burned through me.

I pulled her by the hand to the bedroom. I could feel the heat of her body behind me, it seemed degrees warmer than it should be. Every movement of her legs and shake of her ass sent a shiver of pleasure through me as she let me pull her along.

I turned on her and pushed her into the door to lock it, pressing my body against hers. I wanted her to feel just how aroused I was, just how hard my cock was, and just how I was going to take her. She parted her legs a little to accommodate my cock between them, and bit her lip as my dick rubbed against some pleasurable part of her pussy.

"You have been a very naughty girl, Natalie Blanche-Ossington" I whispered. I pulled at the string of her bikini around her neck, and the straps unraveled. Slowly the material unpeeled to just above her nipple. "You've done some very bad things."

Natalie squirmed as I pressed harder against her. "Did you see it all?" she whispered.

"I don't know," I said. "Did something else happen after upstairs?" I pulled the blue bikini away from her nipples and stroked her left nipple with the pad of my thumb. "How did you get into this swimsuit?"

Natalie grinned wickedly. "Well, I didn't want Ethan to think I didn't care if you suspected something," she said. "And I was all... dirty."

I shivered, and I knew from her expression that she felt my cock throb against her inner thigh. She smiled. Her smile – a peculiar kind of smile derived from her pleasure in teasing me, the knowledge that she could in this particular way - set me on fire.

I dropped my hand to her cutoffs to unbutton them, and she surprised me by placing her own hand on mine to stop me. She leaned close to my ear. "Just wait a second. I have a surprise for you that I think you might like."

She pushed me away from her gently, and because she had me wrapped around her finger, I stepped back without a thought and let her slip past me. She disappeared into the Master Bathroom and went behind the

door in the closet area. I continued backward until I fell backward onto the bed. I tried to see what she was doing through the crack in the door, but I was at a loss.

What other surprise, after all, could she have for me?

When she stepped out from behind the door, I sucked in my breath.

Clever, clever girl. A knot swelled in my stomach (why was she so clever? How?) but quickly dissolved.

Natalie paused with one arm leaning against the doorframe and the other on her hip, which she stuck out sassily.

She was wearing the black bikini from earlier in the day. Earlier in the day when she had fucked Ethan.

She slinked toward me, a knowing, sated smile forming on her lips. I could not control my face, whatever expression it was making. She stopped in front of me, and put both hands on her hips, twisting back and forth a little.

The swimsuit was even more sexy and bondage-like in person. I tugged at one of the strings that dangled just below the cut of the suit on her thigh. I snapped it. I leaned in to inhale right at the center of her legs, sliding my fingers down the hem of the back of the suit, over her ass, down to the center of her legs.

And indeed, the suit was heady with the scent of her pussy, of her cum, and the smell mingled with the acrid scent of a man's cum.

Ethan's cum.

My fingers slid into the fabric. She had somehow kept wet the juices that had drained out of her body and into the material. Her pussy was overflowing now as well. I dipped a finger into her cunt, and she sucked in her breath. Then she climbed onto my lap.

I kept my fingers beneath the fabric of her bikini, and I stroked the sopping juices in a trail from her pussy to her asshole. As I made a circle around her puckered hole, I shivered with the delightful knowledge that it must be a little sore from the rough treatment of Ethan's fingers.

All the better, I couldn't help thinking. I wanted the sore throb to make her think of her naughtiness, her unfaithfulness. To hurt pleurably, like my heart.

I inhaled the scent of her bikini top. The top reeked of the cum of a man. My cock strained painfully against my boxers and my zipper.

“You have been a very, very bad girl,” I said into her breasts. I bit her nipple gently through the fabric of the bikini. It was hard, formed into the squarish pebble that her nipples made when aroused. As I did this, and she gasped a little, I drew her juices from her cunt up to her anus and was unable to stop myself from dipping my pointer finger into the hot, silky flesh inside her ass.

She squirmed and gasped, and I looked up at her. “Does that hurt?” I growled, but before she could complete a nod, I wanted more: “Is your ass sore from letting Ethan fuck you with his hand?”

I pushed my finger in a little further, and she lifted her body up, her asshole squeezing around me in discomfort. But then she let her weight fall back down onto my hand, and I felt her relax. My finger slipped in to her ass to the knuckle.

She rocked back and forth a little, rubbing her dripping pussy on the bulge in my pants.

I opened my mouth in a surprised grin. “You dirty little girl,” I said. Natalie had never said a word about liking this sort of thing, and I had just never... tried. It wasn't a huge thing for me, but now that I had my finger in her ass and it felt so hot, and it was obviously driving her wild, I was getting some very dirty ideas about what I could do with her.

Or what Ethan could do.

Or both of us.

Natalie squeezed her thighs together to push her body back, and I was confused for a moment until she put her hands down at my pants and started to unbuckle my belt and unbutton my pants. The mechanics of getting me out of my pants while I kept my finger in her ass and her on my lap were obviously insurmountable, but we tried for a bit anyway until we looked at each other and laughed.

It was a moment of levity soon gone, as I threw her onto the bed and stood up, getting out of my pants and kicking them off my ankles as fast as I could. I sort of wanted to get her back on my lap like she had been, but now that she was sprawled on the bed, another idea occurred to me.

“Get on your knees,” I said.

Natalie was only too happy to comply. She lay down on the bed with her ass up, and pushed her chest to the bed. The position was wickedly submissive, and I stared at the scene for a moment before I tugged at her sodden panties and slid them down to mid-thigh. Just like before, only now

I was looking at the faintly engorged cunt of a woman who had just been pounded by another man, only hours before. Her asshole seemed to have recovered, but it was slightly red, slightly distended. The kind of faint mark of abuse, almost unnoticeable... just the beginning.

I played with her pussy for a while, dipping my fingers into her lips and making her juices squelch from inside of her. I dragged her excitement up to her asshole, and I made circles around the tender eyelet before I dipped inside of her again.

“So what are you going to let Ethan do to you next?” I said. I guided my cock to her hole, and I pressed the head of it against her. She didn't answer, she only moaned.

“Are you going to let Ethan fuck you in the ass?” I said.

She turned her head, her cheek still pressed to the sheets. Her eyelashes drifted down and then up, as her gaze met mine. She nodded. “Maybe,”

I pushed the head of my cock down, and dipped into her pussy. She was so wet that it was easy to imagine she was also stretched out, loosened up by Ethan's fat cock. I wondered if I felt small to her now – I was a decent sized guy, but Ethan's cock was so fat, surely she noticed the difference.

I was just dipping it in anyway. I slid in and out of her. “Maybe you need some practice first,” I growled.

I pulled my cock out, and pressed it to the tip of her ass. Her body tensed, but she remained where she was. She didn't move away as I pushed forward, the crown of my cock stretching her taut hole, making her twitch and throb. I still hadn't entered her, she was too tight for it. I reached down and drew some more of her juices up to my cock, making it as slick as I could.

For a moment I wasn't sure if I should do it, and then she brought her hands up to either side of her ass and clutched it submissively for me. The signal was clear.

I pushed ahead, and I felt the crown of my cock enter the heat of her body. It was tough going for a second or two, and then she suddenly relaxed, and I slid in to the velvet folds of her ass another few inches. She was closed up around me tight, and surprisingly the insides of her ass were as silky-velvety as her cunt.

She let out a pained moan. “Oh, god, wait,” she said, “No, it's...no, don't stop,”

I pushed a little further. She turned her face to the sheets and bit them, and I felt her ass squeeze me again. I put a hand on her lower back. "Relax," I said.

She suddenly unfolded, from the inside out, and my cock just... sank, deeper and deeper, until I was entirely sheathed in her hot ass.

Jesus.

She squirmed beneath me, and put her hands down on the sheets. "Just, wait," she said. "Oh, give me a minute," she breathed into the sheets. Her body twisted around my cock and I wasn't sure if I could wait much longer.

After a few moments she pushed herself up on her hands. She looked back at me. "Okay," she said. She bit her lip. "Okay, now I'm ready. Fuck me slowly."

I put my hands on her hips and slowly tipped my hips back, drawing the length of my cock out to the last few inches. Then I pushed myself slowly back in.

"Oh god," she said. "Fuck."

I had no idea what that meant, but she seemed content to have me keep going, and my cock by now was aching for release. I stared down at the length of my shaft as I slowly drew it out of her again, and then pushed back inside of her.

She reached her hand down to her clit as she lowered herself back onto the bed again. The shift in her weight and her position made her ass squeeze my cock harder. I let her adjust herself, I think I breathed, "Ready?" and she moaned something incomprehensible into the covers. I watched her hands clawing at the duvet, pulling the fabric up into a bunched and sweaty mess by her head as I withdrew and then pushed in. Her fingers, wildly playing with her slit, scraped across my balls. The sloshing of her fingers in her cunt assailed my ears, and then I had the thought that sent me over the edge, whether she was ready or not: I was stretching my wife out for Ethan to fuck.

I thrust in and out of her rapidly as my climax boiled over and then I gave a last thrust, deep into the hot silk of her ass as I exploded. My cum spurted inside of her and I felt her hand flailing against her clit to make herself come. When she did, her ass spasmed around my pulsing cock, almost painfully. I shouted, unable to contain myself, and collapsed on top of her, pushing her body down flat against the sheets. For a few moments

the pleasure of her ass around me, wet and squeezing, was almost too intense to bear. I was paralyzed by the feel of her.

Finally, I realized that she was breathing shallowly against the weight of my body, and I slipped from inside of her. My cock flopped out as I rolled to the side and pulled her to me in a spoon. Her juices drenched both of our legs, and we lay there, panting.

I pushed her hair from her face. It was sticky with sweat, and strands of it clung to her cheeks. A few tears had dripped from her eyes. I kissed her ear. "You okay?" I said.

Natalie nodded. Her legs were still quivering.

I was a little concerned: maybe I had taken things too far. But Natalie rolled over, twisting so that she was still enveloped by my arms. Her eyes met mine. She kissed me, and put a finger to my lips. It was wet with her cum, and I sucked the sweet liquid from her fingertips.

"Wow," was all I could say.

As the effects of sex died down, I realized with no small amount of pleasure that there was no way Ethan hadn't heard the commotion in the room, even with the doors and windows closed. I knew it was perverse, setting things up to get Ethan to have sex with my wife, and then gloating inside my own mind about taking her back and him having to listen to it, but I couldn't help myself.

Natalie smiled, as if reading my thoughts, though I would never know if she had the same thought as me. I trailed my hand down her chest, and tugged at the black bikini, all of its straps disheveled and sweaty. "That's some suit," I said.

Natalie closed her eyes, and for a moment I wondered if I had said the wrong thing, but then her mouth broke into a wide grin. I kept moving down her torso, and when I brushed over her ribs, notoriously ticklish, she jerked and pulled her feet up, and rolled back onto her stomach. She propped herself up on her elbows and turned her head, giving her hair a toss.

She used one hand to tug at a strand of hair that clung to her cheek.

We looked at each other. I kissed her, and her mouth felt familiar and unfamiliar at the same time.

"I have another one," she said, the same naughty smile on her face.

I must have looked confused.

"Another suit," she said.

But she had much, much more than just “another suit,” I could see by her devilish smile.

END

[Skip to excerpt from "The Houseguest Part 2"](#)

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

*If you enjoyed **The Houseguest**,
give my other novels a try!*

*See **[My Author Page](#)** for a complete list of books, or
peruse the blurbs and titles here.*

[Body of Research](#)

When ever-suspicious Chris plays private detective on his wife's phone and finds that she uses dozens of dating apps, he worries that his darkest fantasies have come true. And it may not be as delicious as he had imagined.

It turns out that Jen is up to something other than cheating, and the door is open for the two of them to explore the boundaries of their marriage. But in any experiment, the results can be unexpected...

[A Conventional Hotwife](#)

Paul Banks was thrilled when a luggage mix-up five years ago opened a window of opportunity for his long-buried desires. Since that time, he and

his wife have been playing a little game at their yearly company conventions, and every year his wife ups the ante, going further into his fantasies. But Kathy Banks might be getting just a bit out of control, and things might be going a little too far...

Or not.

Grand Slam: An Interracial Hotwife Adventure

Charles keeps a secret desire about his wife Zoe. Her sizzling beauty is typically hidden under scrubs and a hair bun, so his fantasy may never happen. But a wrong turn on a weekend getaway turns out to be the opening pitch of a very naughty game, and Zoe seems determined to knock it out of the park.

A Well-Laid Trap (2-Part Series)

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

Opening Up

If you are a fan of Arnica Butler but missed her first few novels, or if you prefer scorchingly hot but romantic fare, enjoy this bundle containing Arnica Butler's previously published, light and fun hotwife novels: ***The Hotwife Summer, The Hotwife Tattoo*** and ***A Gamble***. These novels are not in KU, but the whole set can be yours for only \$4.99!

Ela's Performance

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect solution: get a “hobby job.” Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's “hobby job” make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to is wife – maybe even himself?

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about

Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

Well-Constructed Affairs

As a hot female construction engineer, John's wife Adria draws a lot of attention at the job site. Which isn't all bad. But when Adria opens the door for him to tell her about his sexual fantasies, he doesn't realize she has opened the door on her own – very dark – fantasy as well. A fantasy she hasn't shared with anyone until now. The couple are off on an exploration of their desires...but is their marriage well-constructed enough to withstand the forces of their fantasies?

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken.

But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative

as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

Enjoy this excerpt from the upcoming sequel to *The Houseguest*:

Natalie frowned as I finished up my sales pitch.

She went deadly, unhappily silent.

“What?” I said.

She stared at the ceiling and pulled the sheets up over her, almost as if she wanted more modesty.

A bad feeling coated the inside of my body.

“*You're* not feeling sorry for him now, are you?”

Natalie pressed her lips together. “Not... well...”

“Because he *did* fuck his friend's wife,” I said. It sounded harsher than I meant it to, but something about Natalie's attitude was making me wildly uncomfortable, getting the paranoia flowing again in my veins. I wasn't

even really sure why, given that I had just suggested the idea of telling Ethan the truth because *I* had feelings of guilt.

I just... didn't want Natalie to feel that way.

Deep down inside, I wanted Natalie to feel the opposite way. I wanted Natalie to view him as someone to be used to further my fantasy, and then discard.

She shot me a look. "I mean... okay, but we set him up."

My jealousy flared. My face stung with anger.

It was just as I had suspected, she was getting feelings for him. My thoughts charged ahead with this idea like a freight train.

"Are you getting feelings for him?" I attacked.

Natalie rolled over and pressed a hand flat to my chest. "Hey," she said.

"Calm down. Don't be like that."

"Like what?"

I was pouting, and that riled me even more. I knew that even if I was right, and Natalie was getting feelings for Ethan, I really didn't have the right to complain. That had been the gamble, that had been the thrill – that Natalie's feelings were on the table. But it was burning a hole through my head just thinking about it.

You're such a fucking idiot, Erik, I told myself.

"Erik!" Natalie's voice was a sharp whisper. She snapped her fingers above my face. "Look, don't blow this out of proportion. I just... I feel for the guy." She pressed her lips together, sucking them in slightly. "You weren't there when he was talking about his wife. He's... really beat up about the divorce."

The idea of Natalie having a heart-to-heart with Ethan about his divorce incensed me to the point I couldn't even talk. I just moved my mouth like a stupid fish.

"Don't you see," I finally seethed, "that that's all just a bunch of shit he told you to get you to fuck him?"

Natalie sat up like a bolt of lightening and threw the covers off of herself. She folded up to her knees and looked down at me with the most vicious expression I had ever seen on her face. "*Excuse me?*" she said.

I raised my eyebrows.

My brain *was* reviewing the words that had just come out of my mouth, and I *did* have a sneaking suspicion that I had said something incredibly stupid, and I was just getting around to what it was, when Natalie sorted it for me:

“Do you think,” she said, waving a hand around as if there were an audience in the room, “that I am such a fucking *idiot*, that I'm some bimbo, who doesn't have any idea when a guy is lying to me to get into my pants? Is it... do you actually think I would just be *so* bowled over by him crying about his divorce that I would go have sex with him? You *told me* to do this!” She jutted her chin and looked at the ceiling. “Agghh!” she hollered. “I swear to God!” She stood up and stomped into the bathroom.

I'll confess: this turned me on quite a bit.

But I had problems to solve, and so I flung myself wildly around in my mind, searching for answers.

“Nat,” I said, to buy myself some time.

She started brushing her teeth like she wanted them to fall out of her mouth.

“Okay, that was out of line.”

She spat into the sink. “You think?”

She started brushing again.

I looked at my hands. “Look, I just...”

She stopped brushing and raised her eyebrows at me in the mirror. “Whuh? Though I wuh some kinuh idiot? Well, I'm not.”

She wiped a bit of dribbled toothpaste from her chin angrily. Then she spat, tossed the toothbrush at the sink and headed for the shower.

I got out of bed and approached the shower slowly.

I was less and less clear on why she was so angry.

Natalie got pretty ticked if someone insinuated that she had been conned or done something stupid. I hadn't meant that... had I?

I flipped through the conversation we'd just had.

Oh.

I guess I had.

“It isn't that,” I said after a while. “It's...”

Nat turned slowly in the shower, like I wasn't even there.

What was it? Why had I lashed out at her like that?

“Look, it makes me sort of touchy that you're talking about Ethan's feelings,” I admitted.

It stung, admitting that.

Natalie stopped turning circles in the shower and wiped the steam away from the glass door to stare at me. She looked like she was about to yell something, and then she stepped back. The water from the shower ran down her body, and the steam slowly fogged up the glass again. Her pretty

nipples, her trimmed snatch, her softly curved thighs faded away. “I don't get it,” she said.

Her voice was, to my relief, a degree cooler.

I was cold. Actually cold, temperature-wise.

“Can I come in there?” I said. “I'm freezing.”

No answer for a moment, and I was sure I was in the doghouse for real, when she erupted in a snort. “Explain this nonsense to me and I'll let you in,” she said.

I cast a glance at the towels about five feet away. They were a better bet, but I leaned on the shower and looked up at the ceiling. I let out a sigh. “Okay. It's... look, I know this sounds shitty, but... I'm not okay with you... I don't know, feeling sorry for Ethan or having some kind of...”

“Emotional relationship?” she offered.

I shrugged. “With him,” I finished.

Natalie turned off the water. The door popped open. “Look,” she said. She pointed at a towel and I leaned over to grab it and hand it to her, for some reason not wanting to move my feet. She wrapped it around herself and pushed some water out of her face. I tried very hard – and failed – not to stare at the rivulets of water snaking down her chest, between her breasts, traveling down to her patch of snatch. “I'm not having an emotional relationship with him. I just... think the thing you've proposed is... harsh. I mean, the guy *did* just get divorced.”

“And then hop into bed with his friend's wife,” I said.

Natalie wrung out her hair. “You *are*...” she shook her head, unable to find an appropriate word to finish her sentence.

“I know,” I said. I didn't have a word for myself either, but I got the gist of it.

Natalie stepped toward me and rested her arms on my shoulders. The towel slipped loose without falling off her body. “Look,” she said. “I'm only doing this because we agreed to do it. It's fun. It's exciting, but... Ethan's not my kind of guy.”

“So you aren't attracted to him?” I said, furrowing my brow.

Natalie kissed me and leaned close to me. She pressed her body against me, and I was sure she could feel my erection through the towel. “I mean, I'm *attracted* to him,” she said, grabbing my cock and giving it a squeeze. “Just not... *attracted* to him.”

“So you don't “like-him,” like him,” I said, rolling my eyes and using the elementary-school language to indicate that I felt this was infantile, but deep down inside really desperate to hear an answer to the question.

Natalie laughed. “I don't “like-him” like him. I like Erik Ossington.”

She squeezed my cock again.

And then, so soon – too soon, I would later think, to have thought of it on the fly like that - she said:

“I have another plan. For taking care of the... predicament we've created.

And I think maybe you'll like it.”